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Ephesians

Ephesians - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Ephesians

1. Greeting and prayer for the spiritual blessings in Christ (1:1–23)
2. Sin and salvation (2:1–10)
3. Unity and peace (2:11–22)
4. Mystery of Christ in the believers, made known (3:1–13)
5. Prayer for riches of his glory to make the believers strong (3:14–21)
6. Unity of the Spirit, building up the Body of Christ (4:1–16)
7. New life (4:17–32)
8. Imitators of God (5:1–21)
9. 1 Wives and husbands; children and parents; slaves and masters (5:22–6:9)
10. Armor of God (6:10–20)
11. Final greeting (6:21–24)

Who wrote the book of Ephesians?
Paul wrote Ephesians. Paul was from the city of Tarsus. He had been known as Saul in his early life. Before becoming a Christian, Paul was a Pharisee. He persecuted Christians. After he became a Christian, he traveled several times throughout the Roman Empire telling people about Jesus.

The Apostle Paul helped start the church in Ephesus on one of his trips. He also lived in Ephesus for a year and a half and helped the believers there. Paul probably wrote this letter while he was in prison in Rome.

What is the book of Ephesians about?
Paul wrote this letter to the Christians in Ephesus to explain God's love for them in Christ Jesus. He described the blessings that God was giving them because they were now united with Christ. He explained that all believers are united together, whether Jew or Gentile. Paul also wanted to encourage them to live in a way that pleases God.

How should the title of this book be translated?
Translators may choose to call this book by its traditional title, "Ephesians." Or they may choose a clearer title, such as "Paul's Letter to the Church in Ephesus" or "A Letter to the Christians in Ephesus." (See: How to Translate Names)

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

What was the "mystery" in the book of Ephesians?
The expression translated in the ULT as "mystery" or "hidden" occurs six times. By it, Paul always meant something that God had to reveal to human beings because they could not know it on their own. It always referred to something about how God planned to save mankind. Sometimes it was about his plan to bring about peace between himself and mankind. Sometimes it was more specifically about his plan to save both Jews and Gentiles by uniting them through Christ. This hidden truth was that Gentiles are now able to benefit from the promises of Christ as equals with the Jews.

What did Paul say about salvation and righteous living?
Paul said much about salvation and righteous living in this letter and in many of his letters. He said that God has been very kind and saved Christians because they believe in Jesus. Therefore, after they become Christians, they should live in a righteous way to show that they have faith in Christ. (See: righteous, righteousness, unrighteous, unrighteousness, upright, uprightness)

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

Singular and plural "you"
In this book, the word "I" refers to Paul. The word "you" is almost always plural and refers to the believers who may read this letter. The three exceptions to this are: 5:14, 6:2, and 6:3. (See: Forms of You)

What did Paul mean by the "new self" or the "new man"?
When Paul spoke of the "new self" or the "new man," he meant the new nature that a believer receives from the Holy Spirit. This new nature was created in God's image (See: 4:24). The phrase "new man" is also used for God bringing about peace between Jews and Gentiles. God brought them together as one people group that belong to him (See: 2:15).

How are the ideas of "holy" and "sanctify" represented in Ephesians in the ULT?
The scriptures use such words to indicate any one of several ideas. For this reason, it is often difficult for translators to represent them well in their versions. In translating into English, the ULT uses the following principles:

- Sometimes the meaning in a passage implies moral holiness. Especially important for understanding the gospel is the use of "holy" to express the fact that God views Christians as sinless because they are united to Jesus Christ. Another use of "holy" is to express the idea that God is perfect and faultless. A third use is to express the idea that Christians are to conduct themselves in a blameless, faultless manner in life. In these cases, the ULT uses "holy," "holy God," "holy ones," or "saints." (See: 1:1, 4)
- Sometimes the meaning in a passage indicates a simple reference to Christians without implying any particular role filled by them. In these cases, the ULT uses "saint" or "saints."
- Sometimes the meaning in a passage implies the idea of someone or something set apart for God alone. In these cases, the ULT uses "set apart," "dedicated to," or "reserved for." (See: 3:5)

The UST will often be helpful as translators think about how to represent these ideas in their own versions.

What did Paul mean by the expression "in Christ," "in the Lord," etc.?
This kind of expression occurs in 1:1, 3, 4, 6, 7, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 15, 20; 2:6, 7, 10, 13, 15, 16, 18, 21, 22; 3:5, 6, 9, 11, 12, 21; 4:1, 17, 21, 32; 5:8, 18, 19; 6:1, 10, 18, 21. Paul meant to express the idea of a very close union between Christ and the believers. Please see the introduction to the book of Romans for more details about this kind of expression.

What are the major issues in the text of the book of Ephesians?
- "in Ephesus" (1:1). Some of the earliest manuscripts do not include this phrase. It is likely that Paul intended this letter to be read in many churches, including Ephesus and many other cities. He may have originally left a blank space for the city name to be filled in by those copying the letter and carrying it to different cities. But "Ephesus" is the only name found on manuscripts that have a city name. Therefore, the ULT, UST, and many modern versions include it.
- "because we are members of his body" (5:30). Most modern versions, including the ULT and UST, read in this way. Some older versions read, "because we are members of his body and of his bones." Translators might decide to choose the second reading if other versions in their area have it that way. If translators choose the second reading, they should put the additional words inside square brackets ([ ]) to indicate that they are probably not original to the book of Ephesians.

(See: Textual Variants)

Ephesians - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

"I pray"
Paul structures part of this chapter like a prayer of praise to God. But Paul is not just talking to God. He is teaching the church in Ephesus. He also tells the Ephesians how he is praying for them.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Predestination
Many scholars believe this chapter teaches on a subject known as "predestination." See the use of the word "predestine" in 1:5, 11. Some scholars take this to indicate that God has, from before the foundation of the world, chosen some people to save. Christians have different views on what the Bible teaches on this subject, so translators need to take extra care when translating this chapter. (See: predestine, predestined)

Ephesians 1:1 (#3)

ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ

"in Christ Jesus"

The phrase **in Christ Jesus** and similar expressions are metaphors that frequently occur in the New Testament letters. They express the strongest kind of relationship possible between Christ and those who believe in him, picturing believers as being surrounded by Christ. Alternate translation: [in close relationship to Christ Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:1 (#1)

Paul names himself as the writer of this letter to the believers in the church at Ephesus (and elsewhere). Except where noted, all instances of "you" and "your" refer to the Ephesian believers as well as to all believers, and so are plural.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Ephesians 1:1 (#2)

Παῦλος, ἀπόστολος Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ & τοῖς ἁγίοις τοῖς οὖσιν

"Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus & to the saints, the ones being"

Your language may have a particular way of introducing the author of a letter and the intended audience. Alternate translation: [I, Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ ... write this letter to you, God's holy people]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Ephesians 1:2 (#1)

χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη

"Grace to you and peace"

This is a common greeting and blessing that Paul often uses in the beginning of his letters. Use a form in your language that makes it clear that this is a greeting and blessing.

See: Blessings

Ephesians 1:3 (#1)

In this book, unless otherwise stated, the words "us" and "we" refer to Paul, the believers in Ephesus, and all believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive 'We'

Ephesians 1:3 (#2)

This verse provides background information about the Ephesians to help readers understand their spiritual condition. Paul opens his letter by talking about the believers' position and their safety before God.

See: Background Information

Ephesians 1:3 (#6)

ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις

"in the heavenly {places"

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that the word **heavenly** refers to the place where God is. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the supernatural world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 1:3 (#5)

πάσῃ εὐλογίᾳ πνευματικῇ

"every spiritual blessing"

Alternate translation: [every blessing coming from the Spirit of God]

Ephesians 1:3 (#4)

ὁ εὐλογήσας ἡμᾶς

"the one having blessed us"

Alternate translation: [for God has blessed us]

Ephesians 1:3 (#7)

ἐν Χριστῷ

"in Christ"

Here, **in Christ** could mean: (1) a metaphor referring to our close relationship with Christ. Alternate translation: [by uniting us with Christ] or [because we are united with Christ]; (2) what Christ has done. Alternate translation: [through Christ] or [through what Christ has done]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:3 (#3)

εὐλογητὸς ὁ Θεὸς καὶ Πατὴρ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"Blessed {be} the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [Let us praise the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 1:4 (#1)

ἁγίους καὶ ἀμώμους

"holy and blameless"

Paul uses the two similar words **holy** and **blameless** to emphasize moral goodness. If your language does not have two similar words, you can use one word for both, as in the UST.

See: Doublet

Ephesians 1:4 (#2)

ἀμώμους

"blameless"

The word **blameless** contains two negative ideas: "blame" or "fault," and "-less," which means "without." If it would be helpful in your language, the two negative ideas can be replaced with the corresponding positive idea, "perfect."

See: Double Negatives

Ephesians 1:5 (#5)

διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

“through Jesus Christ”

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that God brought believers into his family by the work of **Jesus Christ**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 1:5 (#4)

εἰς υἱοθεσίαν

“for adoption”

Here, **adoption** is a metaphor that refers to becoming part of God’s family. Alternate translation: [to become his children]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:5 (#2)

προορίσας ἡμᾶς εἰς υἱοθεσίαν

“he predestined us for adoption”

The word **us** refers to Paul, the Ephesian church, and all believers in Christ. Alternate translation: [God planned long ago to adopt us]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Ephesians 1:5 (#1)

προορίσας & αὐτόν & αὐτοῦ

“he predestined & himself & his”

The words “he,” “himself,” and “his” refer to God.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Ephesians 1:5 (#3)

προορίσας ἡμᾶς

“he predestined us”

Alternate translation: [God chose us ahead of time] or [God chose us long ago]

Ephesians 1:6 (#2)

τῷ ἠγαπημένῳ

“the Beloved One”

Alternate translation: [the One he loves, Jesus Christ] or [his Son, whom he loves]

Ephesians 1:6 (#1)

ἐχαρίτωσεν ἡμᾶς ἐν τῷ ἠγαπημένῳ

“he has freely given us in the Beloved One”

Alternate translation: [he has kindly given to us by means of the One whom he loves]

Ephesians 1:7 (#2)

τὸ πλοῦτος τῆς χάριτος αὐτοῦ

“the riches of his grace”

Paul speaks of God’s **grace** as if it were material wealth. Alternate translation: [greatness of God’s grace] or [abundance of God’s grace]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:7 (#1)

διὰ τοῦ αἵματος αὐτοῦ

“through his blood”

The **blood** of Jesus is a metonym for his death. Alternate translation: [because he died]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 1:8 (#3)

σοφίᾳ καὶ φρονήσει

“wisdom and understanding”

Here, **wisdom** and **understanding** mean very similar things. If your language does not have two similar words, you can use one word for both.

See: Doublet

Ephesians 1:8 (#1)

ἧς ἐπερίσσευσεν εἰς ἡμᾶς

“which he caused to abound to us”

Alternate translation: [which he gave us in a great amount] or [being extremely kind to us]

Ephesians 1:8 (#2)

ἐν πάσῃ σοφίᾳ καὶ φρονήσει

“in all wisdom and understanding”

This could mean: (1) because he has all wisdom and understanding. (2) so that we might have great wisdom and understanding.

Ephesians 1:9 (#1)

κατὰ τὴν εὐδοκίαν αὐτοῦ

“according to his good pleasure”

This could mean: (1) because he wanted to make it known to us. (2) which was what he wanted.

Ephesians 1:9 (#2)

ἣν προέθετο ἐν αὐτῷ

“which he had planned in him”

Alternate translation: [as he demonstrated this purpose in Christ]

Ephesians 1:9 (#3)

ἐν αὐτῷ

“in him”

Alternate translation: [by means of Christ]

Ephesians 1:10 (#1)

εἰς οἰκονομίαν

“with a view to an administration”

A new sentence could be started here. Alternate translation: [He did this with a view to an administration] or [He did this, thinking about a stewardship]

Ephesians 1:10 (#2)

τοῦ πληρώματος τῶν καιρῶν

“of the fullness of time”

Alternate translation: [when the time is right] or [at the time that he has appointed]

Ephesians 1:10 (#3)

ἐν αὐτῷ

“in him”

Alternate translation: [under his rule] or [under his authority]

Ephesians 1:11 (#1)

καὶ ἐκληρώθημεν, προορισθέντες

“we were also allotted as a possession. We were predestined”

Both pronouns **we** and **We** are inclusive in this verse. Paul is referring to all Christians, who were predestined to belong to Christ. In verses 12 and 13 he will divide this group into “we” (exclusive) Jewish Christians and “you” Gentile Christians.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Ephesians 1:11 (#2)

καὶ ἐκληρώθημεν

“we were also allotted as a possession”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. This could mean: (1) God also chose us to be his possession. (2) God also chose us to be heirs.

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 1:11 (#3)

προορισθέντες

“We were predestined”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God chose us ahead of time] or [God chose us long ago]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 1:12 (#1)

ἡμᾶς & τοὺς προηλπικότας ἐν τῷ Χριστῷ

“we, the ones having first hoped in Christ”

Here, the word **we** is exclusive and refers to the Jewish believers who first heard the good news, not the believers at Ephesus.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Ephesians 1:12 (#2)

εἰς τὸ εἶναι ἡμᾶς, εἰς ἔπαινον δόξης αὐτοῦ

“so that we & would be for the praise of his glory”

Alternate translation: [so that we ... would live to praise him for his glory]

Ephesians 1:13 (#1)

Paul has been speaking in the previous two verses about himself and the other Jewish believers, but now he begins speaking about the Ephesian believers.

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Ephesians 1:13 (#2)

τὸν λόγον τῆς ἀληθείας

“the word of truth”

This could mean: (1) the message about the truth. (2) the true message.

Ephesians 1:13 (#4)

ἐσφραγίσθητε

“were sealed”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God has sealed you]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 1:13 (#3)

ἐσφραγίσθητε τῷ Πνεύματι τῆς ἐπαγγελίας, τῷ Ἁγίῳ

"were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit"

In this metaphor Paul pictures the **Holy Spirit** as a seal, comparing him to the wax that was placed on a letter and stamped with a symbol representing the person who wrote the letter. Paul uses this custom as a picture to show how God has used the Holy Spirit to assure us that we belong to him. Alternate translation: [God has placed the Holy Spirit that he promised on you as if he were a seal]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:14 (#1)

ἀρραβὼν τῆς κληρονομίας ἡμῶν

"a down payment of our inheritance"

Receiving that which God has promised is spoken of in terms of one inheriting property or wealth from a family member. Alternate translation: [an initial portion that we will receive from what God has promised] or [a guarantee that we will receive what God has promised to give us]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:15 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο

"Because of this"

The connecting phrase **Because of this** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that the Ephesians had believed the gospel and had been sealed by the Holy Spirit. The result is that Paul praises God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 1:16 (#1)

οὐ παύομαι εὐχαριστῶν

"I have not stopped giving thanks"

Paul is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Paul uses **not stopped** to emphasize that he continues to thank God. Alternate translation: [I continue to thank God]

See: Litotes

Ephesians 1:16 (#2)

οὐ παύομαι εὐχαριστῶν

"I have not stopped giving thanks"

Paul uses this exaggeration to emphasize that he thanks God very often. Alternate translation: [I continue to thank God] or [I often thank God]

See: Hyperbole

Ephesians 1:17 (#2)

πνεῦμα σοφίας καὶ ἀποκαλύψεως, ἐν ἐπιγνώσει αὐτοῦ

"a spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him"

Alternate translation: [spiritual wisdom to understand his revelation]

Ephesians 1:17 (#1)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that Paul prays for the Ephesians. The result is that God would enlighten the Ephesians about all that he has done for them through Christ. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 1:18 (#5)

τῆς κλήσεως αὐτοῦ

"of his calling"

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that the **calling** of God refers to his choosing people to believe in him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [that you have because he chose you to be his people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 1:18 (#3)

τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς τῆς καρδίας

“the eyes of your heart”

The phrase **eyes of your heart** is a metaphor for one’s ability to gain understanding. Alternate translation: [that you may gain understanding and be enlightened]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:18 (#6)

τῆς κληρονομίας αὐτοῦ

“of his inheritance”

Receiving what God has promised to believers is spoken of as if one were inheriting property and wealth from a family member.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:18 (#2)

πεφωτισμένους τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς τῆς καρδίας

“the eyes of your heart having been enlightened”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [that God may give you understanding] or [that God may enlighten your mind]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 1:18 (#4)

πεφωτισμένους

“having been enlightened”

Alternate translation: [may be made to see]

Ephesians 1:18 (#1)

πεφωτισμένους τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς τῆς καρδίας

“the eyes of your heart having been enlightened”

Here, **heart** refers to a person’s mind or thinking. Alternate translation: [that you may gain understanding]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 1:18 (#7)

τοῖς ἁγίοις

“the saints”

Alternate translation: [those whom he has set apart for himself] or [those who belong completely to him]

Ephesians 1:19 (#2)

εἰς ἡμᾶς, τοὺς πιστεύοντας

“toward us, the ones believing”

Alternate translation: [for us who believe]

Ephesians 1:19 (#4)

τοῦ κράτους τῆς ἰσχύος αὐτοῦ

“of the force of his strength”

The words **force** and **strength** have very similar meanings and may be combined. Alternate translation: [of his great strength]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 1:19 (#1)

τὸ ὑπερβάλλον μέγεθος τῆς δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ

“the incomparable greatness of his power”

Alternate translation: [God’s power, which is far beyond all other power]

Ephesians 1:19 (#3)

τὴν ἐνέργειαν τοῦ κράτους τῆς ἰσχύος αὐτοῦ

“the working of the force of his strength”

Alternate translation: [his great power that is at work for us]

Ephesians 1:20 (#3)

καθίσας ἐν δεξιᾷ αὐτοῦ, ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις

“seated {him} at his right hand in the heavenly places”

The one who sits at the **right hand** of a king sits at his right side and rules with all the authority of the king at whose right hand or side he sits. This is a metonym of location that represents the authority that the person in that location possesses. Alternate translation: [gave him all authority to rule from heaven]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 1:20 (#2)

ἐκ νεκρῶν

“from the dead”

This expression describes all **dead** people together in the underworld. To come back from among them speaks of becoming alive again. Alternate translation: [from among all those who have died]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Ephesians 1:20 (#4)

καθίσας ἐν δεξιᾷ αὐτοῦ

“seated {him} at his right hand”

To sit at the **right hand** of God is a symbolic action meaning “receiving great honor and authority from God.” Alternate translation: [seated him in the place of honor and authority beside him]

See: Symbolic Action

Ephesians 1:20 (#5)

ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις

“in the heavenly places”

The word **heavenly** refers to the place where God is. See how you translated this in Ephesians 1:3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 1:20 (#1)

ἐγείρας αὐτὸν ἐκ νεκρῶν

“having raised him from the dead”

Alternate translation: [when he made him alive again]

Ephesians 1:21 (#4)

ἐν τῷ αἰῶνι τούτῳ

“in this age”

Alternate translation: [at this time]

Ephesians 1:21 (#5)

ἐν τῷ μέλλοντι

“in the one coming”

Alternate translation: [in the future]

Ephesians 1:21 (#3)

ὀνόματος

“name”

Here, **name** could refer to: (1) a title. (2) a position of authority.

Ephesians 1:21 (#1)

ὑπεράνω πάσης ἀρχῆς, καὶ ἐξουσίας, καὶ δυνάμεως, καὶ κυριότητος

“far above all rule and authority and power and dominion”

These are all terms for the ranks of supernatural beings, both angelic and demonic. If your language does not have four different terms for rulers or authorities, you can combine them. Alternate translation: [far above all types of supernatural beings]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 1:21 (#2)

παντὸς ὀνόματος ὀνομαζομένου

“every name being named”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. This could mean: (1) every name that man gives. (2) every name that God gives.

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 1:22 (#1)

ὑπὸ τοὺς πόδας αὐτοῦ

“under his feet”

Here, **feet** represents Christ’s lordship, authority, and power. Alternate translation: [under Christ’s power]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 1:22 (#2)

κεφαλὴν ὑπὲρ πάντα

“head over all things”

Here, **head** is a metaphor that refers to the leader or the one who is in charge. Alternate translation: [ruler over all things]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:23 (#1)

τὸ σῶμα αὐτοῦ

“his body”

Just as the head (verse 22) rules all things pertaining to a human body, so Christ is the head of the church **body**.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 1:23 (#3)

τὸ πλήρωμα

“the fullness”

This could have: (1) a passive sense, which would mean that Christ fills or completes the church. (2) an active sense, which would mean that the church completes Christ (as a body completes a head).

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 1:23 (#2)

τὸ πλήρωμα τοῦ τὰ πάντα ἐν πᾶσιν πληρουμένου

“the fullness of the one filling all in all”

Alternate translation: [for Christ fills the church with his life and power just as he gives life to all things]

Ephesians - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter focuses on the life that a Christian had before coming to believe in Jesus. Paul then uses this information to explain how a person’s former way of living is distinct from a Christian’s new identity “in Christ.” (See: faith)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

One body

Paul teaches about the church in this chapter. The church is made of two different groups of people (Jews and Gentiles). They are now one group or “body.” The church is also known as the body of Christ. Jews and Gentiles are united in Christ.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“Dead in trespasses and sins”

Paul teaches that those who are not Christians are “dead” in their sin. Sin binds or enslaves them. This makes them spiritually “dead.” Paul writes that God makes Christians alive in Christ. (See: sin, sinful, sinner, sinning; and faith; and Metaphor)

Descriptions of worldly living

Paul uses many different ways to describe how non-Christians act. They “lived according to the ways of this world” and are “living according to the ruler of the authorities of the air,” “fulfilling the evil desires of our sinful nature,” and “carrying out the desires of the body and of the mind.”

“It is the gift of God”

Some scholars believe “it” here refers to being saved. Other scholars believe that it is faith that is the gift of God. Because of how the Greek tenses agree, “it” here probably refers to both things: the gift is that we are saved by God’s grace through faith.

Flesh

“Flesh” is sometimes used as a metaphor for a person’s sinful nature. The phrase “Gentiles in the flesh” indicates the Ephesians once lived without any concern for God. But “flesh” is also used in this verse to refer to the physical person, similar to “body part of man.”

Ephesians 2:1 (#3)

τοῖς παραπτώμασιν καὶ ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις ὑμῶν

“in your trespasses and sins”

The words **trespasses** and **sins** have similar meanings. Paul uses them together to emphasize the greatness of the people’s sin. If your language has just one word for this, the two words can be combined. Alternate translation: [your many sins]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 2:1 (#4)

τοῖς παραπτώμασιν καὶ ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις ὑμῶν

“in your trespasses and sins”

The words **trespasses** and **sins** are abstract nouns that represent actions. You could use an adjective or a verb for this if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because of the sinful things that you did] or [because you were always sinning against God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 2:1 (#2)

ὑμᾶς ὄντας νεκροὺς τοῖς παραπτώμασιν καὶ ταῖς ἁμαρτίαις ὑμῶν

“you were dead in your trespasses and sins”

This shows how the inability of a sinful person to obey God is similar to a **dead** person’s inability to respond physically. Alternate translation: [you were spiritually dead, unable to do anything but sin]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:1 (#1)

Paul reminds the believers of their past and the way they now are before God.

Ephesians 2:2 (#3)

τὸν ἄρχοντα τῆς ἐξουσίας τοῦ ἀέρος

“the ruler of the authorities of the air”

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that this phrase refers to the devil or Satan. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Satan, the ruler of the authorities of the air]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 2:2 (#1)

ἐν αἷς ποτε περιεπατήσατε

“in which you once walked”

Here, "walk" is a metaphor for the way a person lives. Alternate translation: [which is how you lived] or [which you did habitually]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:2 (#2)

κατὰ τὸν αἰῶνα τοῦ κόσμου τούτου

"according to the age of this world"

The apostles often used **world** to refer to the selfish behaviors and corrupt values of the people living in this world. Alternate translation: [according to the values of people living in the world] or [following the principles of this present world]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 2:2 (#5)

τοῖς υἱοῖς τῆς ἀπειθείας

"the sons of disobedience"

Alternate translation: [people who routinely disobey God]

See: Idiom

Ephesians 2:2 (#4)

τοῦ πνεύματος τοῦ νῦν ἐνεργοῦντος

"the spirit that is now working"

Alternate translation: [the spirit of Satan, who is currently working]

Ephesians 2:3 (#1)

τὰ θελήματα τῆς σαρκὸς καὶ τῶν διανοιῶν

"the desires of the body and of the minds"

The words **body** and **minds** represent the entire person. Alternate translation: [the selfish things that people want to do]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 2:3 (#2)

τέκνα & ὀργῆς

"children of wrath"

Alternate translation: [people with whom God is angry]

See: Idiom

Ephesians 2:4 (#2)

ὁ & Θεὸς πλούσιος ὢν ἐν ἐλέει

"God being rich in mercy"

The word **mercy** is an abstract noun. Alternate translation: [God is abundantly merciful] or [God is very kind to us]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 2:4 (#3)

διὰ τὴν πολλὴν ἀγάπην αὐτοῦ, ἣν ἠγάπησεν ἡμᾶς

"because of his great love with which he loved us"

The word **love** is an abstract noun. Alternate translation: [because he loved us so very much]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 2:4 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

The connecting word **But** introduces a contrast relationship. The love and mercy of God is in sharp contrast to the evil way the Ephesians lived before they believed in God.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 2:5 (#1)

χάριτί ἐστε σεσῳσμένοι

"by grace you have been saved"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God saved you by being gracious to you]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 2:5 (#2)

χάριτί ἐστε σεσῳσμένοι

"by grace you have been saved"

The word **grace** is an abstract noun. Alternate translation: [God saved you by being extremely kind to you] or [God saved you as a free gift]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 2:6 (#3)

συνεκάθισεν

"seated us with {him"

Paul talks about the believers as already **seated** in heaven with Christ because, although it is something that will happen in the future, it was guaranteed by

what Christ did in the past. Alternate translation: [it is as though God has already seated us next to Christ]

See: Predictive Past

Ephesians 2:6 (#4)

ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις

“in the heavenly places”

The phrase **heavenly places** refers to the place where God is. See how this is translated in Ephesians 1:3. Alternate translation: [in the supernatural world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 2:6 (#1)

συνήγειρεν

“raised us up with {him”

Here, **raised up** is an idiom for causing someone who has died to become alive again.

See: Idiom

Ephesians 2:6 (#2)

συνήγειρεν

“raised us up with {him”

This could mean: (1) because God has caused Christ to come alive again, God has already given Paul and the believers in Ephesus new spiritual life. Alternate translation: [God has given us new life because we belong to Christ]; (2) because God has caused Christ to come alive again, the believers in Ephesus can know that after they die they will live with Christ, and Paul can speak of the believers living again as if it has already happened. Alternate translation: [we can be sure that God will give us life just as he has caused Christ to come alive again]

See: Predictive Past

Ephesians 2:6 (#5)

ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ

“in Christ Jesus”

The phrase **in Christ Jesus** and similar expressions are metaphors that frequently occur in the New Testament letters. They express the strongest kind of relationship possible between Christ and those who believe in him.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:7 (#2)

ἐν τοῖς αἰῶσιν, τοῖς ἐπερχομένοις

“in the ages that are coming”

Alternate translation: [in the future]

Ephesians 2:7 (#1)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of God raising up believers and seating them in heaven with Christ is to show the extent of his grace in Christ.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 2:8 (#4)

τοῦτο

“this {is”

The pronoun **this** refers back to **by grace you have been saved by faith**.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Ephesians 2:8 (#3)

τῇ γὰρ χάριτί ἐστε σεσῳσμένοι

“For by grace you have been saved”

See how you translated this phrase in Ephesians 2:5.

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 2:8 (#1)

γὰρ

“For”

The connecting word **For** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that the Ephesians had been saved by God and not by their own good works. The result is that people would see the grace of God to us in Christ. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 2:8 (#2)

τῇ γὰρ χάριτί ἐστε σεσῳσμένοι διὰ πίστεως

“For by grace you have been saved through faith”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God saved you by grace because of your faith in him]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 2:9 (#1)

οὐκ ἐξ ἔργων, ἵνα μή τις καυχήσηται

“not from works, so that no one may boast”

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. You may want to start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [Salvation does not come from works, so that no one may boast] or [God does not save a person because of what that person does, so no one can boast and say that he earned his salvation]

See: Ellipsis

Ephesians 2:9 (#2)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of God for saving believers by grace instead of by their works is that no person might boast, speaking as if they saved themselves.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 2:10 (#4)

ἐν αὐτοῖς περιπατήσωμεν

“we would walk in them”

To **walk** on a path is a metaphor for how a person lives his life. Here, **in them** refers to the **good works**. Alternate translation: [we would always and continually do those good deeds]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:10 (#1)

γάρ

“For”

The connecting word **For** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that God is the one who created us to do any good works that we do. The result is that people cannot boast. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 2:10 (#2)

ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ

“in Christ Jesus”

The phrase **in Christ Jesus** and similar expressions are metaphors that frequently occur in the New Testament letters. They express the strongest kind of relationship possible between Christ and those who believe in him.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:10 (#3)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of God creating us as he did is that we would do the good works that he intended for us to do.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 2:11 (#4)

περιτομῆς

“circumcised”

This was another term for Jewish people because all male infants were **circumcised**. Alternate translation: [circumcised people]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 2:11 (#1)

διὸ

“Therefore”

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that they were saved by God and not by anything they had done on their own. The result is that the Ephesians would remember that they were once separated from God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 2:11 (#2)

τὰ ἔθνη ἐν σαρκί

“were} Gentiles in the flesh”

Here, **Gentiles** refers to people who were not born Jewish.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:11 (#3)

ἀκροβυστία

"uncircumcised"

Non-Jewish people were not circumcised as babies, so the Jews considered them people who do not follow any of God's laws. Alternate translation: [uncircumcised pagans]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 2:11 (#5)

ὑπὸ τῆς λεγομένης

"by the ones being called"

You can translate this with an active form. Alternate translation: [by what people call] or [by those whom people call]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 2:12 (#1)

ὅτι

"For"

The connecting word **For** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that they were not part of the Jews, who were circumcised. The result is that the Gentile Ephesians were separated from God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 2:12 (#3)

ξένοι τῶν διαθηκῶν τῆς ἐπαγγελίας

"strangers to the covenants of the promise"

Paul speaks to the Gentile believers as if they had been foreigners, kept out of the land of God's **covenants** and **promise**.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:12 (#2)

χωρὶς Χριστοῦ

"apart from Christ"

Alternate translation: [unbelievers]

Ephesians 2:13 (#3)

ἐν τῷ αἵματι τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"by the blood of Christ"

The **blood of Christ** is a metonym for his death. Alternate translation: [by Christ's death] or [when Christ died for us]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 2:13 (#2)

ὑμεῖς οἵ ποτε ὄντες μακρὰν, ἐγενήθητε ἐγγὺς ἐν τῷ αἵματι τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"you, the ones once being far away have been brought near by the blood of Christ"

Not belonging to God due to sin is spoken of as **being far away** from God. Belonging to God because of **the blood of Christ** is spoken of as being **brought near** to God. Alternate translation: [you who once did not belong to God now belong to God because of the blood of Christ]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:13 (#1)

δὲ

"But"

The connecting word **But** introduces a contrast relationship. The current condition of the Ephesian Gentile believers, after they believed in Christ, is that they are near to God. That is in contrast to their previous condition, before they believed in Christ, of being separated from God.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 2:14 (#2)

αὐτὸς & ἐστιν ἡ εἰρήνη ἡμῶν

"he himself is our peace"

Alternate translation: [Jesus gives us his peace]

Ephesians 2:14 (#1)

γάρ

"For"

The connecting word **For** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that Christ himself joined them to the Jewish believers. The result is that the Ephesian Gentile believers were brought near to God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 2:14 (#3)

ἡ εἰρήνη ἡμῶν

“our peace”

The word **our** refers to Paul and his readers and so, it is inclusive.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Ephesians 2:14 (#6)

τὸ μεσότοιχον τοῦ φραγμοῦ & τὴν ἔχθραν

“the middle wall of partition, the hostility”

The **hostility** between the Jews and Gentiles is compared to a **wall**. Alternate translation: [the hostility that was like a wall that separated them]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:14 (#4)

ὁ ποιήσας τὰ ἀμφότερα ἓν

“the one having made the two one”

Alternate translation: [who made the Jews and Gentiles one]

Ephesians 2:14 (#5)

ἐν τῇ σαρκὶ αὐτοῦ

“in his flesh”

The phrase **his flesh**, his physical body, is a metonym for his body dying. Alternate translation: [by the death of his body on the cross]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 2:15 (#1)

τὸν νόμον τῶν ἐντολῶν ἐν δόγμασιν καταργήσας

“He abolished the law of the commandments in regulations”

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that Jesus’ blood satisfies the law of Moses so that both the Jews and Gentiles can live at peace in God. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [He took away the requirements in the law of Moses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 2:15 (#4)

ἐν αὐτῷ

“in himself”

Being joined to Christ is what makes reconciliation possible between Jews and Gentiles. Paul describes this relationship as though Christ surrounded all of us. Alternate translation: [because he made it possible]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:15 (#2)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of Christ in abolishing the law was to join the Jews and the Gentiles together into one group.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 2:15 (#3)

ἕνα καινὸν ἄνθρωπον

“one new man”

Paul talks about the unity of Jews and Gentiles as if they had become **one** person. Alternate translation: [a single new people]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:16 (#4)

ἀποκτείνας τὴν ἔχθραν

“putting to death the hostility”

Ending their **hostility** is spoken of as if Christ killed their hostility. By dying on the cross, Jesus eliminated the reason for Jews and Gentiles to be hostile toward each other. Neither are now required to live according to the law of Moses. Alternate translation: [stopping them from hating one another]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:16 (#3)

διὰ τοῦ σταυροῦ

“through the cross”

The **cross** here represents Christ’s death on the cross. Alternate translation: [by means of Christ’s death on the cross]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 2:16 (#2)

ἐν ἑνὶ σώματι

“as one body”

The church is often pictured as the **body** of Christ, who is its head. Here it is comprised of both Jews and Gentiles.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:16 (#1)

ἀποκαταλλάξῃ τοὺς ἀμφοτέρους

“so that he might reconcile both”

Alternate translation: [so that Christ might bring the Jews and the Gentiles together in peace]

Ephesians 2:17 (#1)

εὐηγγελίσατο εἰρήνην

“and} proclaimed peace”

Paul tells the Ephesians that Gentile believers are also now just as much a part of God’s people as are Jewish believers. The Jewish apostles and prophets are theirs, as is Christ, and they all form a temple for God in the Spirit. Alternate translation: [and announced the gospel of peace] or [declaring the gospel of peace]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 2:17 (#2)

ὑμῖν τοῖς μακρὰν

“to you, the ones far away”

Paul pictures the Gentiles (non-Jews), who were not part of God’s people, as though they were physically distant from God.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:17 (#3)

τοῖς ἐγγύς

“to the ones near”

Paul pictures the Jews, who were God’s people by birth, as though they were physically close to God.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:18 (#1)

ὅτι δι’ αὐτοῦ ἔχομεν τὴν προσαγωγὴν, οἱ ἀμφότεροι

“for through him both have access”

Here, **both** refers to Paul and the rest of the believing Jews, and it also refers to the believing non-Jews.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Ephesians 2:18 (#3)

ἐν ἑνὶ Πνεύματι

“in one Spirit”

The implication is that all believers, both Jewish and Gentile, are enabled to enter into the presence of God the Father by the same Holy **Spirit**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by means of the same Spirit]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 2:18 (#2)

ὅτι

“for”

The connecting word **for** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that he himself is the one who enabled both Jew and Gentile to come to the Father. The result is that Christ proclaimed peace to both the Jews and the Gentiles. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 2:19 (#3)

ἀλλὰ

“Instead”

The connecting word **Instead** introduces a contrast relationship. The previous separation of the Ephesians from God is in contrast to their current status as citizens of the kingdom of God and members of his household.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 2:19 (#4)

ἐστὲ συνπολῖται τῶν ἁγίων καὶ οἰκεῖοι τοῦ Θεοῦ

“you are fellow citizens with the saints and {members} of the household of God”

Paul is again speaking of the spiritual condition of Gentiles after they become believers as he would speak about foreigners becoming **citizens** of a different nation.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:19 (#2)

ξένοι καὶ πάροικοι

“strangers and foreigners”

The words **strangers** and **foreigners** have very similar meanings and may be combined. Alternate translation: [people who had no relationship to God]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 2:19 (#1)

ἄρα οὖν

"So then"

The connecting phrase **So then** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that Christ gave them access to God through the Spirit. The result is that the Ephesian believers are no longer separated from God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 2:20 (#1)

ἐποικοδομηθέντες ἐπὶ τῷ θεμελίῳ

"been built on the foundation"

Paul speaks of God's people as if they were a building. Christ is the cornerstone, the apostles are the **foundation**, and the believers are the structure. Alternate translation: [you depend on the teaching]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:20 (#2)

ἐποικοδομηθέντες

"been built"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God has built you]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 2:21 (#1)

πᾶσα οἰκοδομὴ συναρμολογουμένη, αὔξει εἰς ναὸν ἅγιον

"the whole building, being fit together, grows into a holy temple"

Paul continues to speak of Christ's family as if it were a **building**. In the same way that a builder fits stones together while building, so Christ is fitting us together. Alternate translation: [all of us, as we grow together, become a holy group that worships God]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:21 (#2)

ἐν ᾧ & ἐν Κυρίῳ

"in whom & in the Lord"

These metaphors express the strongest kind of relationship possible between Christ and those who believe in him. Alternate translation: [In Christ ... in the Lord Jesus]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:22 (#1)

ἐν ᾧ

"in whom"

You can translate this as "in Christ," which is a metaphor that expresses the strongest kind of relationship possible between Christ and those who believe in him.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:22 (#2)

καὶ ὑμεῖς συνοικοδομεῖσθε, εἰς κατοικητήριον τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐν Πνεύματι

"you also are being built together into a dwelling place for God in the Spirit"

This describes how believers are being put together to become a **place** where **God** will permanently live through the power of the Holy **Spirit**. Alternate translation: [you also are being joined to this group where God lives by his Spirit]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 2:22 (#3)

καὶ ὑμεῖς συνοικοδομεῖσθε

"you also are being built together"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God is also building you together]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

"I pray"
Paul structures part of this chapter as a prayer to God. But Paul is not just talking to God. He is both praying for and instructing the church in Ephesus.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Mystery
Paul refers to the church as a "mystery." The role of the church in the plans of God was once not known. But God has now revealed it. Part of this mystery involves the Gentiles having equal standing with the Jews in the plans of God.

Ephesians 3:1 (#1)

τούτου χάριν

"For this reason"

To make clear the hidden truth about the church to believers, Paul refers back to the oneness of Jews and Gentiles and how believers from both groups form part of the one group that worships God, like the stones that form one temple. The connecting phrase **For this reason** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is what Paul talked about in Chapter 2, that Christ showed his grace by removing the division between Jews and Gentiles and making them into one group. The result is that Paul prays for the Gentiles. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result. Alternate translation: [This is why]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 3:1 (#3)

ὁ δέσμιος τοῦ Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ

"the prisoner of Christ Jesus"

Alternate translation: [the one who is in prison because I serve Christ Jesus]

Ephesians 3:1 (#2)

τούτου χάριν

"For this reason"

You may need to make explicit what the reason is. Alternate translation: [Because of God's grace to you,] You may also need to make explicit here what the result is, as in the UST, because Paul does not state the result, that he prays for them, until 3:14.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 3:2 (#1)

τὴν οἰκονομίαν τῆς χάριτος τοῦ Θεοῦ, τῆς δοθείσης μοι εἰς ὑμᾶς

"the stewardship of the grace of God that was given to me for you"

Here, **grace** could mean: (1) the gift of the gospel that Paul is bringing to the Gentiles. Alternate translation: [the responsibility that God gave me to bring his grace to you]; (2) the gift to Paul of being the steward of the gospel for the Gentiles. Alternate translation: [the responsibility that God graciously gave me for your benefit]

Ephesians 3:3 (#2)

καθὼς προέγραψα ἐν ὀλίγῳ

"about which I already wrote in brief"

Paul refers here to another letter that he had written to these people.

See: Background Information

Ephesians 3:3 (#1)

κατὰ ἀποκάλυψιν ἐγνωρίσθη μοι

"according to a revelation made known to me"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [according to what God revealed to me]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 3:5 (#2)

ὡς νῦν ἀπεκαλύφθη & ἐν Πνεύματι

"as it now has been revealed by the Spirit"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [but now the Spirit has revealed it] or [but now the Spirit has made it known]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 3:5 (#1)

ὃ ἑτέραις γενεαῖς οὐκ ἐγνωρίσθη τοῖς υἱοῖς τῶν ἀνθρώπων

"which in other generations was not made known to the sons of men"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God did not make these things known to people in the past]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 3:6 (#1)

εἶναι τὰ ἔθνη, συνκληρονόμα & διὰ τοῦ εὐαγγελίου

“that the Gentiles are to be fellow heirs & through the gospel”

Paul assumes that his readers will understand **that the Gentiles are to be fellow heirs**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. This is the hidden truth that Paul began to explain in the previous verse. The **Gentiles** who receive Christ also receive everything that the Jewish believers receive from God.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 3:6 (#2)

σύνσωμα

“fellow members of the body”

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that **Gentiles** are to be **fellow members of the body**. The church is often referred to as “the body of Christ.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [members of the body of Christ]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 3:6 (#4)

διὰ τοῦ εὐαγγελίου

“through the gospel”

This could mean: (1) because of the **gospel**, the Gentiles are fellow sharers in the promise. (2) because of the **gospel**, the Gentiles are fellow heirs and members of the body and fellow sharers in the promise.

Ephesians 3:6 (#3)

ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ

“in Christ Jesus”

The phrase **in Christ Jesus** and similar expressions are metaphors that frequently occur in the New Testament letters. They express the strongest kind of relationship possible between Christ and those who believe in him.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:8 (#2)

πλοῦτος τοῦ Χριστοῦ

“riches of Christ”

Paul speaks of the truth about **Christ** and the blessings he brings as if they were material wealth.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:8 (#1)

ἀνεξιχνίαστον

“unsearchable”

Paul speaks of everything that Christ offers as something so physically vast that it cannot be fully explored. Alternate translation: [unable to be completely known]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:9 (#1)

τοῦ μυστηρίου, τοῦ ἀποκεκρυμμένου ἀπὸ τῶν αἰώνων ἐν τῷ Θεῷ, τῷ τὰ πάντα κτίσαντι

“of the mystery that was hidden from the ages in God, the one having created all things”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [of God, who created all things, kept this plan hidden for long ages in the past]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 3:10 (#3)

ταῖς ἀρχαῖς καὶ ταῖς ἐξουσίαις

“to the rulers and to the authorities”

The words **rulers** and **authorities** share similar meanings. Paul uses them together to emphasize that every spiritual being will know God’s wisdom. If your language does not have two words for this, you can use one. Alternate translation: [ruling authorities]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 3:10 (#1)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of God revealing the mystery of the church to Paul is to enable the rulers in the heavenly places to see the wisdom of God.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 3:10 (#4)

ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις

“in the heavenly places”

The phrase **heavenly places** refers to the place where God is. See how this is translated in Ephesians 1:3. Alternate translation: [in the supernatural world]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 3:10 (#2)

γνωρισθῇ & ταῖς ἀρχαῖς καὶ ταῖς ἐξουσίαις ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις & ἡ πολυποίκιλος σοφία τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the multifaceted wisdom of God might be made known to the rulers and to the authorities in the heavenly places"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God may make his great wisdom known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly places]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 3:10 (#5)

ἡ πολυποίκιλος σοφία τοῦ Θεοῦ

"the multifaceted wisdom of God"

Paul talks of God's **wisdom** as though it were an object with many surfaces. Alternate translation: [the complex wisdom of God] or [how extremely wise God is]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:11 (#1)

κατὰ πρόθεσιν τῶν αἰώνων

"according to the eternal purpose"

Alternate translation: [in keeping with the eternal plan] or [consistent with the eternal plan]

Ephesians 3:12 (#1)

τὴν παρρησίαν καὶ προσαγωγὴν

"boldness and access"

In this section of the prayer, Paul praises God in his sufferings and prays for these Ephesian believers. The two words **boldness** and **access** work together to express one idea. Alternate translation: [bold access] or [boldness to enter]

See: Hendiadys

Ephesians 3:12 (#3)

πεποιθήσει

"confidence"

Alternate translation: [certainty] or [assurance]

Ephesians 3:12 (#2)

προσαγωγὴν ἐν πεποιθήσει

"access with confidence"

It may be helpful to state explicitly that this **access** is into God's presence. Alternate translation: [access into God's presence with confidence] or [freedom to enter into God's presence with confidence]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 3:13 (#1)

διὸ

"Therefore"

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that the believers have access to Christ with confidence. The result is that the believers will not be discouraged. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 3:13 (#2)

ὑπὲρ ὑμῶν, ἥτις ἐστὶν δόξα ὑμῶν

"for you, which is your glory"

Here, **your glory** is a metonym for the salvation and eternal life that the Ephesians will have because of Paul's work of telling them about Christ, which resulted in his suffering in prison. You can state this as a new sentence. Alternate translation: [for you. They bring you a wonderful benefit] or [for you. They result in your salvation]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 3:14 (#3)

κάμπτω τὰ γόνατά μου πρὸς τὸν Πατέρα

"I bend my knees to the Father"

Bent **knees** are a picture of the whole person in an attitude of prayer. Alternate translation: [I bow down in prayer to the Father] or [I humbly pray to the Father]

See: Synecdoche

Ephesians 3:14 (#2)

τούτου χάριν

"For this reason"

You may need to make explicit what the reason is. Alternate translation: [Because God has done all this for you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 3:14 (#1)

τούτου χάριν

"For this reason"

The connecting phrase **For this reason** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that Paul's sufferings have caused glory for the believers. The result is that Paul prays to the Father. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 3:15 (#1)

ἐξ οὗ πᾶσα πατριὰ ἐν οὐρανοῖς καὶ ἐπὶ γῆς ὀνομάζεται

"from whom every family in heaven and on earth is named"

The act of naming here probably also represents the act of creating. Alternate translation: [who created and named every family in heaven and on earth]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 3:16 (#1)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of Paul's prayer is that the Ephesian believers would be strengthened by God in their faith and love.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 3:16 (#3)

δῷ

"he would grant"

Alternate translation: [he would give]

Ephesians 3:16 (#2)

δῷ ὑμῖν κατὰ τὸ πλοῦτος τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ, δυνάμει κραταιωθῆναι

"he would grant you, according to the riches of his glory, to be strengthened with power"

Alternate translation: [God, because he is so great and powerful, would allow you to become strong with his power]

Ephesians 3:17 (#1)

Paul continues the prayer he began in Ephesians 3:14.

Ephesians 3:17 (#2)

κατοικῆσαι τὸν Χριστὸν διὰ τῆς πίστεως ἐν ταῖς καρδίαις ὑμῶν ἐν ἀγάπῃ, ἐρριζωμένοι καὶ τεθεμελιωμένοι

"that Christ may live in your hearts through faith, being rooted and grounded in love"

With the phrase, **that Christ may live** Paul continues the prayer he began in Ephesians 3:14. This is the second item for which Paul prays that God will grant the Ephesians "according to the riches of his glory." The first is that they would be strengthened (Ephesians 3:16).

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Ephesians 3:17 (#3)

κατοικῆσαι τὸν Χριστὸν διὰ τῆς πίστεως ἐν ταῖς καρδίαις ὑμῶν

"that Christ may live in your hearts through faith"

Here, **hearts** represent a person's inner being, and **through** expresses the means by which Christ lives within the believer. Christ lives in the hearts of believers because God graciously allows them to have faith. Alternate translation: [that Christ may live within you because you trust in him]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:17 (#4)

ἐν ἀγάπῃ, ἐρριζωμένοι καὶ τεθεμελιωμένοι

"being rooted and grounded in love"

Paul speaks of their faith as if it were a tree that has deep roots or a house built on a solid foundation. Alternate translation: [you will be like a firmly rooted tree and a building built on stone]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:18 (#2)

καταλαβέσθαι

"to comprehend"

With the introductory phrase, Paul moves to the third item, **to comprehend**, for which he bends his knees and prays; the first is that God will grant that they be strengthened (Ephesians 3:16) and the second is that Christ may live in their hearts through faith (Ephesians 3:17).

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Ephesians 3:18 (#1)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that Christ would live in their hearts. The result is that the Ephesian believers would fully know the love of God and be filled with God’s fullness. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 3:18 (#3)

πᾶσιν τοῖς ἁγίοις

“all the saints”

Alternate translation: [all the believers in Christ]

Ephesians 3:18 (#5)

τὸ πλάτος, καὶ μῆκος, καὶ ὕψος, καὶ βάθος

“the width and length and height and depth”

It may be necessary to state explicitly what these words refer to. If so, you could combine this with the phrase from the next verse. Alternate translation: [the width and length and height and depth of, and truly know the love of Christ] or [the width and length and height and depth of the love of Christ, and truly know it]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 3:18 (#4)

τὸ πλάτος, καὶ μῆκος, καὶ ὕψος, καὶ βάθος

“the width and length and height and depth”

In this metaphor Paul pictures something that is not physical or measurable as something that is physical but stretches out in all directions and, thus, is very large. This could refer to: (1) the intensity of Christ’s love for us. Alternate translation: [how very much Christ loves us]; (2) the greatness of God’s wisdom. Alternate translation: [how very wise God is]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:19 (#4)

ἵνα πληρωθῆτε

“so that you may be filled”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [so that God can fill you]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 3:19 (#1)

γνῶναί τε τὴν & ἀγάπην τοῦ Χριστοῦ

“and to know the love of Christ”

With the conjunction **and**, Paul continues the idea from the previous verse. They both refer to knowing the greatness of the love of Christ. Alternate translation: [that you can know how great Christ’s love for us is]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Ephesians 3:19 (#2)

ἵνα πληρωθῆτε εἰς πᾶν τὸ πλήρωμα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“so that you may be filled with all the fullness of God”

This is the fourth item for which Paul bends his knees and prays (Ephesians 3:14). The first is that they would “be strengthened” (Ephesians 3:16), the second is that “Christ would live in their hearts through faith” (Ephesians 3:17), and the third is that they “could comprehend Christ’s love” (Ephesians 3:18).

Ephesians 3:19 (#5)

εἰς πᾶν τὸ πλήρωμα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“with all the fullness of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **fullness**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [with everything that God is full of]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 3:19 (#6)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that the Ephesian believers would know the love of Christ. The result is that they would be filled with the fulness of God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 3:19 (#3)

ἵνα πληρωθῆτε εἰς πᾶν τὸ πλήρωμα τοῦ Θεοῦ

“so that you may be filled with all the fullness of God”

In this metaphor Paul pictures the Ephesian believers as containers into which **God** can pour himself. Alternate translation: [so God can give you everything that he has to give you]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 3:20 (#1)

The words “we” and “us” in this book continue to include Paul and all believers.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Ephesians 3:20 (#2)

τῷ δὲ

“And to the one”

Paul concludes his prayer by asking God to bless the Ephesian believers. You could express this as either a blessing or a prayer, in whichever way is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Now to God, the one]

See: Blessings

Ephesians 3:20 (#3)

ὑπὲρ πάντα, ποιῆσαι ὑπέρἐκπερισσοῦ ὧν αἰτούμεθα ἢ νοοῦμεν

“to do exceedingly abundantly above all that we ask or think”

Alternate translation: [to do much more than all that we ask or think] or [to do things that are much greater than anything that we ask him for or think about]

Ephesians 3:21 (#1)

αὐτῷ ἡ δόξα ἐν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ

“to him {be} the glory in the church”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **glory**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [may God’s people glorify him] or [may God’s people praise him for how great he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with verse 8, which is quoted from the Old Testament.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Spiritual gifts
Spiritual gifts are specific supernatural abilities that the Holy Spirit gives to Christians after they come to believe in Jesus. These spiritual gifts were foundational to developing the church. Paul lists here only some of the spiritual gifts. (See: faith)

Unity
Paul considers it very important that the church is united. This is a major theme of this chapter.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Old man and new man
The term “old man” probably refers to the sinful nature with which a person is born. The “new man” is the new nature or new life that God gives a person after they come to believe in Christ.

Ephesians 4:1 (#3)

ἀξίως περιπατῆσαι τῆς κλήσεως

“to walk worthily of the calling”

The phrase **to walk** is a common way to express the idea of living one’s life. Because of what Paul has been writing to the Ephesians, he now tells them how they should live their lives as believers, reemphasizing that believers are to agree with each other.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:1 (#2)

ὁ δέσμιος ἐν Κυρίῳ

“the prisoner for the Lord”

Alternate translation: [someone who is in prison because he serves the Lord]

Ephesians 4:1 (#4)

τῆς κλήσεως ἧς ἐκλήθητε

“of the calling by which you were called”

Here, **the calling** refers to the fact that God chose them to be his people. Alternate translation: [because God chose you to be his people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 4:1 (#1)

οὖν

“Therefore”

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that God will be glorified in the church for all generations. The result is that believers should walk in a way that is worthy of the Lord. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 4:2 (#1)

μετὰ πάσης ταπεινοφροσύνης καὶ πραΰτητος

“with all humility and gentleness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the words **humility**, **gentleness**, and **patience**, you could express the same ideas with verbal forms. Alternate translation: [to learn to be humble, gentle, and patient]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:3 (#2)

τηρεῖν τὴν ἑνότητα τοῦ Πνεύματος ἐν τῷ συνδέσμῳ τῆς εἰρήνης

“to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the words **unity** and **peace**, you could express the same ideas with verbal forms. Alternate translation: [to live peacefully with one another and remain united as the Spirit made possible]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:3 (#1)

τηρεῖν τὴν ἑνότητα τοῦ Πνεύματος ἐν τῷ συνδέσμῳ τῆς εἰρήνης

“to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace”

Here Paul speaks of **peace** as if it were a **bond** that ties people together. This is a metaphor for being united with other people by living peacefully with them. Alternate translation: [to live peacefully with one another and remain united as the Spirit made possible]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:4 (#1)

ἓν σῶμα

“There is} one body”

The church is often referred to as the **body** of Christ.

Ephesians 4:4 (#2)

ἓν Πνεῦμα

“one Spirit”

Alternate translation: [only one Holy Spirit]

Ephesians 4:4 (#3)

ἐκλήθητε ἐν μιᾷ ἐλπίδι τῆς κλήσεως ὑμῶν

“you were called in one hope of your calling”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God called you to have one confident hope in your calling] or [there is one thing that God also chose you to be confident in and expect him to do]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 4:6 (#1)

Πατὴρ πάντων & ἐπὶ πάντων & διὰ πάντων & ἐν πᾶσιν

“Father of all & over all & through all & in all”

Alternate translation: [Father of every person ... over every thing ... through all things ... in all things]

Ephesians 4:7 (#1)

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that the poetic material which follows is from a song that King David wrote. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 4:7 (#2)

ἑνὶ & ἑκάστῳ ἡμῶν ἐδόθη ἡ χάρις

“to each one of us this grace has been given”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [God has given grace to each one of us] or [God gave a gift to each believer]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 4:7 (#3)

ἑνὶ & ἑκάστῳ ἡμῶν ἐδόθη ἡ χάρις

“to each one of us this grace has been given”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **grace**, you could express the

same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [God has given a gift to each believer]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:8 (#1)

διὸ

"Therefore"

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that every believer has been given a spiritual gift. The result is that the Scripture says Jesus gave gifts to men. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 4:8 (#2)

ἀναβὰς εἰς ὕψος

"Having ascended to the heights"

Alternate translation: [When Christ went up into heaven]

Ephesians 4:9 (#2)

καὶ κατέβη

"he also descended"

Alternate translation: [Christ also came down]

Ephesians 4:9 (#3)

εἰς τὰ κατώτερα μέρη τῆς γῆς

"into the lower regions of the earth"

This could refer to: (1) the **lower regions** as a part of the **earth**. (2) **the lower regions** as another way of referring to the **earth** itself. Alternate translation: [into the lower regions, the earth]

Ephesians 4:9 (#1)

ἀνέβη

"He ascended"

Alternate translation: [Christ went up]

Ephesians 4:10 (#2)

πληρώσῃ

"he might fill"

Alternate translation: [he might complete] or [he might satisfy]

Ephesians 4:10 (#1)

ἵνα πληρώσῃ τὰ πάντα

"so that he might fill all things"

Alternate translation: [so that he might be working powerfully everywhere]

Ephesians 4:11 (#1)

ποιμένας

"pastors"

The word translated as **pastors** here is the same word that is translated as "shepherds" elsewhere in the ULT. It is the plural form of the word used by Jesus to refer to himself in John 10:10, where he says that he is the "good Shepherd." The idea here is that in a similar way to how a shepherd feeds, protects, and watches over the well-being of his flock, so pastors feed (with spiritual food) and watch over and protect the spiritual well-being of those within their church. If it would help your readers, you could indicate explicitly the meaning of the word "pastors." Alternate translation: [spiritual shepherds] or [shepherding Christian leaders]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 4:12 (#5)

τοῦ σώματος τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"of the body of Christ"

Alternate translation: [all of the members of Christ's church] or [all those who are believers in Christ]

Ephesians 4:12 (#4)

οἰκοδομὴν

"building up"

Alternate translation: [the improvement]

Ephesians 4:12 (#3)

εἰς οἰκοδομὴν τοῦ σώματος τοῦ Χριστοῦ

"for building up of the body of Christ"

Paul is speaking of people who grow spiritually as if they were doing exercises to increase the strength of their physical bodies.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:12 (#1)

πρὸς τὸν καταρτισμὸν τῶν ἁγίων

"for the equipping of the saints"

Alternate translation: [to prepare the people whom he has set apart] or [to provide the believers with what they need]

Ephesians 4:12 (#2)

εἰς ἔργον διακονίας

“for the work of serving”

Alternate translation: [so that they can serve others]

Ephesians 4:13 (#1)

καταντήσωμεν οἱ πάντες εἰς τὴν ἑνότητα τῆς πίστεως, καὶ τῆς ἐπιγνώσεως τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“we all reach to the unity of the faith and the knowledge of the Son of God”

The implication is that the believers need to know Jesus as the **Son of God** if they are to be united in **faith** and become mature as believers. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. [we all join together in our belief and relationship with Jesus the Christ]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 4:13 (#2)

καταντήσωμεν οἱ πάντες εἰς τὴν ἑνότητα τῆς πίστεως

“we all reach to the unity of the faith”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **unity**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [we all become equally strong in faith] or [we all become united together in faith]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:13 (#5)

τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“of the Son of God”

Son of God is an important title for Jesus.

See: Translating Son and Father

Ephesians 4:13 (#3)

καταντήσωμεν οἱ πάντες εἰς τὴν ἑνότητα τῆς πίστεως

“we all reach to the unity of the faith”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **faith**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [become united together as believers]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:13 (#4)

τῆς ἐπιγνώσεως τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“the knowledge of the Son of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **knowledge**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [all know well the Son of God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:13 (#7)

τέλειον

“mature”

Alternate translation: [fully developed] or [grown up] or [complete]

Ephesians 4:13 (#6)

εἰς ἄνδρα τέλειον

“to a mature man”

Alternate translation: [to a mature believer]

Ephesians 4:14 (#3)

κλυδωνιζόμενοι καὶ περιφερόμενοι παντὶ ἀνέμῳ τῆς διδασκαλίας

“tossed back and forth by the waves and carried away by every wind of teaching”

Paul speaks of a believer who has not become mature and follows various wrong teachings as if that believer were a boat and the teachings were the **wind** and **waves** that move the boat in different directions on the water.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:14 (#1)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of gifted people in the church is to bring all the believers to spiritual maturity.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 4:14 (#4)

ἐν τῇ κυβίᾳ τῶν ἀνθρώπων, ἐν πανουργίᾳ πρὸς τὴν μεθοδίαν τῆς πλάνης

“through the trickery of men in cleverness for deceitful scheming”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the words **trickery**, **cleverness**, and **scheming**, you could express the same ideas with verbal forms. Alternate translation: [by crafty people who trick believers with clever lies]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:14 (#2)

μηκέτι ὦμεν νήπιοι

“we may no longer be children”

Paul refers to believers who have not grown spiritually as if they were **children** who have had very little experience in life. Alternate translation: [we may no longer be like children]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:15 (#4)

εἰς αὐτὸν & ὅς ἐστιν ἡ κεφαλή

“into him who is the head”

Paul uses a metaphor of the human body to describe how Christ causes believers to work together in harmony as the **head** of a body causes the body parts to work together to grow in a healthy way.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:15 (#1)

δὲ

“Instead”

The connecting word **Instead** introduces a contrast relationship. Following every changing teaching is in contrast to becoming mature in Christ and building up his body. Use a word in your language that indicates contrast.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 4:15 (#3)

ἐν ἀγάπῃ

“in love”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **love**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [as the members love one another]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:15 (#2)

ἀληθεύοντες

“speaking truth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **truth**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [speaking truthfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:16 (#3)

ἐν ἀγάπῃ

“in love”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **love**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [as the members love one another] or [to be able to love each other more]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:16 (#4)

διὰ πάσης ἁφῆς τῆς ἐπιχορηγίας

“by every supporting ligament”

Paul continues the metaphor comparing the believers to a human body. A **ligament** is a strong band that connects bones or holds organs in place in the body. Just as the body is held together by strong ligaments, so the believers are held together by love that grows stronger as the body parts grow and work together.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:16 (#2)

εἰς οἰκοδομὴν ἑαυτοῦ ἐν ἀγάπῃ

“for building up itself in love”

The word **for** indicates a purpose clause. The purpose of all of the believers working together in harmony, as the members of a human body do, is so that all believers will grow in our ability to love each other and to love God. Use a word in your language that marks this as a purpose clause.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 4:16 (#1)

ἐξ οὗ πᾶν τὸ σῶμα & τὴν αὔξησιν τοῦ σώματος ποιεῖται

“from whom the whole body & causes the growth of the body”

Paul continues the metaphor of the believers as a human **body** with Christ as the head to describe how Christ causes believers to work together in harmony as the head of a body causes the body parts to work together to grow in a healthy way.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:17 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship in which Paul tells them what they should no longer do now that they, as believers, are sealed by the Holy Spirit of God. The reason is that Christ wants every believer to become spiritually mature and to serve the other believers. The result is that the Ephesian believers should no longer act as the Gentiles act. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 4:17 (#4)

μηκέτι ὑμᾶς περιπατεῖν, καθὼς καὶ τὰ ἔθνη περιπατεῖ ἐν ματαιότητι τοῦ νοὸς αὐτῶν

"you & to walk no longer as the Gentiles also walk, in futility of their minds"

Paul commonly uses this metaphor that compares walking to living one's life. Alternate translation: [you ... to stop living like the Gentiles with their worthless thoughts]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:17 (#3)

ἐν Κυρίῳ

"in the Lord"

This could be: (1) referring to the authority of the Lord. (2) stating that we all belong to the Lord.

Ephesians 4:17 (#2)

τοῦτο οὖν λέγω καὶ μαρτύρομαι

"Therefore, I say this and strongly urge"

Alternate translation: [Because of what I have just said, I will now say something more in order to strongly encourage]

Ephesians 4:18 (#2)

ἐσκοτωμένοι τῇ διανοίᾳ

"They have been darkened in their understanding"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [Their way of thinking has become dark] or [They no longer think or reason clearly] or [They are not able to understand]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 4:18 (#6)

διὰ τὴν πώρωσιν τῆς καρδίας αὐτῶν

"because of the hardness of their hearts"

The phrase **hardness of their hearts** is a metaphor that means "stubbornness." Alternate translation: [because they are stubborn] or [because they refuse to listen to God]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:18 (#3)

ἀπηλλοτριωμένοι τῆς ζωῆς τοῦ Θεοῦ, διὰ τὴν ἄγνοιαν τὴν οὖσαν ἐν αὐτοῖς

"alienated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [because they do not know God, they cannot live the way that God wants his people to live] or [they have cut themselves off from the life of God by their ignorance]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 4:18 (#4)

ἀπηλλοτριωμένοι

"alienated"

Alternate translation: [cut off] or [separated]

Ephesians 4:18 (#5)

ἄγνοιαν

"ignorance"

Alternate translation: [lack of knowledge] or [lack of information]

Ephesians 4:18 (#7)

διὰ

"because of"

The connecting word **because** introduces a reason-result relationship. The first reason is that they are ignorant of him. The result is that the Gentiles are separated from God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 4:18 (#8)

διὰ

"because of"

Again, the connecting word **because** introduces a reason-result relationship. The second reason is that their hearts are hardened. The result is that Gentiles are separated from walking with God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 4:18 (#1)

ἐσκοτωμένοι τῇ διανοίᾳ

"They have been darkened in their understanding"

This metaphor compares wrong thinking with darkness. Alternate translation: [they no longer think or reason clearly] or [they are not able to understand]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:19 (#1)

ἑαυτοὺς παρέδωκαν τῇ ἀσελγείᾳ

"handed themselves over to sensuality"

Paul speaks of these people as if they were objects that they themselves were giving to other people, and he speaks of the way that they want to satisfy their physical desires as if the desires were the person to whom they give themselves. Alternate translation: [have given in to every physical desire] or [only want to satisfy their physical desires]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:20 (#1)

ὑμεῖς δὲ οὐχ οὕτως ἐμάθετε τὸν Χριστόν

"But you did not thus learn about Christ"

The word **thus** refers to the way that the Gentiles live, as described in Ephesians 4:17–19. Paul uses **thus** to emphasize strongly that what the believers learned from Christ was the opposite of what he just described. Alternate translation: [But what you learned about the ways of Christ was not like that] or [But what you learned about the ways of Christ was very different]

See: Exclamations

Ephesians 4:20 (#2)

δὲ

"But"

The connecting word **But** introduces a contrast relationship. The sinful way the Gentiles live is in contrast to the way that Paul taught the Ephesians to live according to the truth of Jesus. Use a connecting word in your language that marks a contrast here

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 4:21 (#1)

εἴ γε αὐτὸν ἠκούσατε καὶ ἐν αὐτῷ ἐδιδάχθητε

"if indeed you have heard about him and were taught in him"

Paul knows that the people to whom he is writing have **heard** and been **taught** these things. He is using irony as a form of rebuke—if they are doing things contrary to the way of Christ, they know better than that and need to stop.

See: Irony

Ephesians 4:21 (#3)

καθώς ἐστιν ἀλήθεια ἐν τῷ Ἰησοῦ

"as the truth is in Jesus"

Alternate translation: [as Jesus teaches us the true way to live] or [as everything about Jesus is true]

Ephesians 4:21 (#2)

ἐν αὐτῷ ἐδιδάχθητε

"were taught in him"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. This could mean: (1) they received instruction in his ways. (2) Jesus' people have taught them.

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 4:22 (#4)

τὸν φθειρόμενον κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας τῆς ἀπάτης

"being corrupted according to {its} deceitful desires"

Paul is continuing to speak of a sinful way of living as if it were a person who does evil things. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when you fooled yourself into thinking that it was good to do whatever evil thing that you wanted to do]

See: Personification

Ephesians 4:22 (#1)

ἀποθέσθαι ὑμᾶς κατὰ τὴν προτέραν ἀναστροφὴν

"You are to put aside {what} belongs to your former manner of life"

Paul is speaking of moral qualities as if they were pieces of clothing. Alternate translation: [You must stop living according to your former manner of life]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:22 (#3)

τὸν παλαιὸν ἄνθρωπον

"the old man"

The **old man** refers to the "old nature" or "former self," the way that the person was before the person became a believer in Christ

See: Personification

Ephesians 4:22 (#2)

ἀποθέσθαι ὑμᾶς κατὰ τὴν προτέραν ἀναστροφὴν τὸν παλαιὸν ἄνθρωπον

"You are to put aside {what} belongs to your former manner of life, the old man"

Paul is speaking of a way of living as if it were a person. Alternate translation: [You must stop doing the things that your former self did] or [Stop doing the things that you used to do]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:23 (#1)

ἀνανεοῦσθαι & τῷ πνεύματι τοῦ νοὸς ὑμῶν

"to be renewed in the spirit of your minds"

This may be translated with an active form. Alternate translation: [to allow God to change your attitudes and thoughts] or [to allow God to give you new attitudes and thoughts]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 4:24 (#1)

ἐν δικαιοσύνῃ καὶ ὁσιότητι τῆς ἀληθείας

"in righteousness and holiness of the truth"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the words **righteousness**, **holiness**, and **truth**, you could express the same ideas with verbal forms. Alternate translation: [truly righteous and holy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:24 (#2)

ἐνδύσασθαι τὸν καινὸν ἄνθρωπον

"to put on the new man"

Paul continues to speak of a way of living as if it were a person, and also as if it were clothing, so that one could **put on** the **new** person like a robe. Alternate translation: [be the new person] or [start living in the new way]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:25 (#3)

λαλεῖτε ἀλήθειαν ἕκαστος

"let each of you speak truth"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **truth**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [each of you should speak truthfully]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:25 (#5)

ἐσμὲν ἀλλήλων μέλη

"we are members of one another"

Paul speaks of the close union of believers with each other as if they were each part of one single body. Alternate translation: [we belong to one another] or [we are all members of God's family]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:25 (#1)

διὸ

"Therefore"

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that God has created the believers as new, holy people. The result is that they would stop acting immorally like they used to

live. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 4:25 (#4)

ὅτι

"because"

The connecting word **because** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that believers are members of the same body of Christ. The result is that believers should speak the truth to each other. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 4:25 (#2)

ἀποθέμενοι τὸ ψεῦδος

"putting aside the lying"

Paul speaks of telling lies as if they were objects that the believers could set aside. Alternate translation: [no longer telling lies] or [instead of telling lies]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:26 (#2)

ὁ ἥλιος μὴ ἐπιδυέτω ἐπὶ παροργισμῷ ὑμῶν

"Do not let the sun go down on your indignation"

The **sun** going **down** represents nightfall or the end of the day. Alternate translation: [You must stop being angry before night comes] or [Let go of your anger before the day ends]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 4:26 (#1)

ὀργίζεσθε, καὶ μὴ ἁμαρτάνετε

"Be angry and do not sin"

Alternate translation: [You may get angry, but do not sin] or [If you become angry, do not sin]

Ephesians 4:27 (#1)

μηδὲ δίδοτε τόπον τῷ διαβόλῳ

"nor give an opportunity to the devil"

Alternate translation: [and do not give the devil an opportunity to lead you into sin]

Ephesians 4:28 (#1)

μᾶλλον δὲ

"But rather"

The connecting phrase **But rather** introduces a contrast relationship. The way a former thief should work hard to have something to share with others is in contrast to the way he formerly stole for himself.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 4:28 (#2)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of working hard with ones own hands is to be able to meet the needs of others.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 4:29 (#1)

λόγος σαπρὸς

"corrupt talk"

The phrase **corrupt talk** refers to speech that is cruel or rude. If your readers would not be familiar with this term, you could use the more familiar term in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [foul language] or [unwholesome words] or [abusive speech]

See: Translate Unknowns

Ephesians 4:29 (#3)

πρὸς οἰκοδομὴν

"for building up"

Alternate translation: [for encouraging] or [for strengthening]

Ephesians 4:29 (#4)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of speaking things that build up others is to give grace to those who hear the words.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 4:29 (#6)

ἵνα δῷ χάριν τοῖς ἀκούουσιν

“so that it might give grace to the hearers”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **grace**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [so that those who hear you may be spiritually encouraged]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:29 (#5)

τῆς χρείας, ἵνα δῷ χάριν τοῖς ἀκούουσιν

“of the {one in} need, so that it might give grace to the hearers”

Alternate translation: [the needy. In this way you will help those who hear you]

Ephesians 4:29 (#2)

ἀλλ’

“but”

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. Speaking what is corrupt is in contrast to speaking good things that will build up others.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 4:30 (#3)

ἐν ᾧ ἐσφραγίσθητε εἰς ἡμέραν ἀπολυτρώσεως

“by whom you were sealed for the day of redemption”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [for he has sealed you for the day of redemption]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 4:30 (#1)

μὴ λυπεῖτε

“do not grieve”

Alternate translation: [do not distress] or [do not upset]

Ephesians 4:30 (#2)

ἐν ᾧ ἐσφραγίσθητε εἰς ἡμέραν ἀπολυτρώσεως

“by whom you were sealed for the day of redemption”

The Holy Spirit assures believers that God will redeem them. Paul speaks of the Holy Spirit as if he were a mark that God puts on believers to show that he owns them. Alternate translation: [for he is the seal that assures you that God will redeem you on the day of redemption] or [for he is the one who assures you that God will redeem you on the day of redemption]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:31 (#1)

ἀρθήτω

“Let & be removed”

Paul finishes his instructions on what believers should not do and ends with what they must do. Paul speaks of attitudes and behaviors as though they were physical objects that can be removed. Alternate translation: [you must not allow ... to be part of your life]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 4:31 (#3)

κακίᾳ

“malice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **malice**, you could express the same idea as an adjective. Alternate translation: [being malicious]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:31 (#2)

πικρία, καὶ θυμὸς, καὶ ὀργὴ

“bitterness, and rage, and anger”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the words **bitterness**, **rage**, and **anger**, you could express the same ideas as adjectives. Alternate translation: [being bitter, and intensely angry, and angry]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 4:32 (#2)

εὔσπλαγχνοι

“tenderhearted”

Alternate translation: [gentle and compassionate towards others]

Ephesians 4:32 (#1)

δὲ

“Instead”

The connecting word **Instead** introduces a contrast relationship. Speaking angry and hurtful things is in contrast to speaking kind and tender things to one another.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the words of verse 14.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Inheritance of the kingdom of Christ

Some scholars believe that those who continue to practice the things listed in 5:5 will not inherit eternal life. But God can forgive all the sins listed in this verse. Immoral, impure, or greedy people can still receive eternal life if they repent and believe in Jesus. God will be the one who decides this. (See: forgive, forgiven, forgiveness, pardon, pardoned; eternity, everlasting, eternal, forever; and inherit, inheritance, heir)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Wives, submit to your husbands

Scholars are divided over how to understand this passage in its historical and cultural context. Some scholars believe that men and women are perfectly equal in all things. Other scholars believe that God created men and women to serve in distinctly different roles in marriage and the church. Translators should be careful not to let how they interpret this issue affect how they translate this passage.

Ephesians 5:1 (#1)

γίνεσθε οὖν μιμηταὶ τοῦ Θεοῦ

“Therefore, be imitators of God”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **imitators**, you could express the same idea in another way. The word **imitators** is a verbal noun, and can be translated with a verb. Alternate translation: [Therefore, imitate God] or [Therefore you should do what God does.]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 5:1 (#2)

οὖν

“Therefore”

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. Paul continues to tell the believers how they should and should not live as God’s children. The reason (stated in Ephesians 4:32) is that God has forgiven us through Christ. The result (stated here) is that believers should imitate what God is like. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:1 (#3)

ὡς τέκνα ἀγαπητά

“as beloved children”

God desires us to imitate or follow him since we are his spiritual **children**. Alternate translation: [as dearly loved children imitate their fathers] or [because you are his children and he loves you dearly]

See: Simile

Ephesians 5:2 (#1)

περιπατεῖτε ἐν ἀγάπῃ

“walk in love”

To **walk** is a common way to express the idea of living one’s life. Alternate translation: [live a life of love] or [always love each other]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:2 (#2)

προσφορὰν καὶ θυσίαν τῷ Θεῷ εἰς ὀσμὴν εὐωδίας

“an offering and sacrifice to God for a fragrant aroma”

This metaphor compares Christ dying on the cross for our sins with an Old Testament **sacrifice** for sin, which were roasted in a fire and gave off a pleasing smell. Alternate translation: [like a sweet-smelling offering and sacrifice to God] or [an offering and sacrifice to God that pleased God very much]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:3 (#2)

δὲ

“But”

The connecting word **But** introduces a contrast relationship. The fragrant offering and sacrifice to God is in contrast to sinful acts and thoughts that are not fitting for saints. Use a connecting word that indicates a contrast in your language.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:3 (#3)

ἀκαθαρσία πᾶσα

“every impurity”

Alternate translation: [any moral uncleanness]

Ephesians 5:3 (#1)

πορνεία δὲ, καὶ ἀκαθαρσία πᾶσα, ἢ πλεονεξία, μηδὲ ὀνομαζέσθω ἐν ὑμῖν

“But sexual immorality and every impurity or greed must not even be named among you”

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [Do not do anything that would let anyone think that you are guilty of sexual immorality or any kind of impurity or greed]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 5:4 (#1)

ἀλλὰ μᾶλλον εὐχαριστία

“but instead, thanksgiving”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **thanksgiving**, you could express the same idea in another way. The word **thanksgiving** is a verbal noun, and can be translated with a verb. Alternate translation: [instead of those things, you should thank God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 5:4 (#2)

ἀλλὰ μᾶλλον

“but instead”

The connecting phrase **but instead** introduces a contrast relationship. Sinful acts and thoughts are in contrast to thanksgiving to God. Use a connecting word that indicates a contrast in your language.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:5 (#1)

ἀκάθαρτος

“unclean”

Being **unclean** (dirty) is a metaphor for being sinful.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:5 (#2)

οὐκ ἔχει κληρονομίαν

“has no inheritance”

Receiving what God has promised believers is spoken of as if it were inheriting property and wealth from a family member. Alternate translation: [will receive nothing] or [has no part]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:6 (#2)

γὰρ

“for”

The connecting word **for** introduces a reason-result relationship. The result is stated first: that the Ephesian believers should not let anyone deceive them with empty words. Then the reason is stated: that the wrath of God will judge those things. Use a phrase that connects a reason to a result, and put them in the order that is most natural in your language.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:6 (#1)

κενοῖς λόγοις

“with empty words”

Alternate translation: [with words that have no truth in them] or [by speaking words that are not true]

Ephesians 5:6 (#3)

ἔρχεται ἡ ὀργὴ τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐπὶ

“the wrath of God is coming upon”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **wrath**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [God will certainly punish]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 5:6 (#4)

τοὺς υἱοὺς τῆς ἀπειθείας

“the sons of disobedience”

This is an idiom that means, “people who habitually disobey” or “people who are characterized by disobedience” Alternate translation: [those who disobey God]

See: Idiom

Ephesians 5:7 (#1)

οὖν

"Therefore"

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that God will judge those people in his wrath. The result is that the Ephesian believers should not become partners with evil men. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:8 (#5)

ὡς τέκνα φωτὸς περιπατεῖτε

"Walk as children of light"

To **Walk** on a path is a metaphor for how a person lives his life. Alternate translation: [Live as people who understand what the Lord wants them to do]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:8 (#2)

γάρ

"because"

The connecting word **because** introduces a reason-result relationship. The result is stated first (v.7): that the Ephesian believers should not become partners with evil men. The reason is stated second (v. 8): that the Ephesian believers are no longer darkness, but are now light. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result, using the order that is most natural for your language.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:8 (#6)

ὡς τέκνα φωτὸς

"as children of light"

God desires us to imitate or follow him since we are his spiritual **children**. Alternate translation: [as God's children who know the truth] or [because you are God's children and see the truth]

See: Simile

Ephesians 5:8 (#3)

νῦν δὲ φῶς ἐν Κυρίῳ

"but now {are} light in the Lord"

Just as one can see in the **light**, so people whom God has saved understand how to please God. Alternate translation: [but now you know God and can live for him]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:8 (#4)

δὲ

"but"

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. The fact that the Ephesian believers were formerly darkness is in contrast to the fact that they are now light.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:8 (#1)

ἦτε γάρ ποτε σκότος

"because formerly you were darkness"

Just as one cannot see in the dark, so people who love to sin cannot see or understand the things of God. Alternate translation: [because formerly you did not understand anything about God]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:9 (#1)

ὁ & καρπὸς τοῦ φωτὸς ἐν πάσῃ ἀγαθωσύνῃ, καὶ δικαιοσύνῃ, καὶ ἀληθείᾳ

"the fruit of the light consists in all goodness and righteousness and truth"

Here, **fruit** is a metaphor for "result" or "outcome." Alternate translation: [the result of living in the light is good work, right living, and truthful behavior]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:9 (#2)

γὰρ

"for"

The connecting word **for** introduces the reason of a reason-result relationship. The reason is that fruit of the light is goodness and righteousness and truth. The result is that the Ephesian believers should walk as children of light. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:11 (#4)

μᾶλλον δὲ

“but rather”

The connecting phrase **but rather** introduces contrast relationship. Participating in the works of darkness is in contrast to exposing them.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:11 (#1)

μὴ συνκοινωνεῖτε τοῖς ἔργοις τοῖς ἀκάρποις τοῦ σκότους

“do not take part in the unfruitful works of darkness”

Paul speaks of the useless, sinful things that unbelievers do as if they are evil deeds that people do in the dark so no one will see them. Alternate translation: [do not do useless, sinful things with unbelievers]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:11 (#3)

τοῖς ἔργοις τοῖς ἀκάρποις τοῦ σκότους

“in the unfruitful works of darkness”

The word **darkness** is often used to represent sin. In this instance, these works result from sinful motives. Alternate translation: [deeds that are worthless because they were done from sinful motives]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:11 (#5)

ἐλέγχετε

“expose {them”

Speaking against the works of darkness is spoken of as bringing them out into the light so that people can see them. Alternate translation: [bring them out into the light] or [uncover them] or [show and tell people how wrong these actions are]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:11 (#2)

τοῖς ἔργοις τοῖς ἀκάρποις τοῦ σκότους

“in the unfruitful works of darkness”

Paul is comparing evil actions to an unhealthy tree that produces nothing good. Alternate translation: [actions that do nothing good, useful, or profitable, caused by darkness]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:12 (#1)

αὐτῶν

“them”

Here, **them** refers to the “sons of disobedience” mentioned in 5:6 and also referred to as “them” in 5:7. If it is unclear who “them” refers to in either place, then use “those who disobey God” or a similar phrase.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Ephesians 5:13 (#1)

δὲ

“But”

The connecting word **But** introduces a contrast relationship. Hiding the shameful works of darkness now is in contrast to the light exposing them later.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:13 (#2)

πᾶν & τὸ φανερούμενον φῶς ἐστιν

“everything that is revealed is light”

Paul makes this general statement in order to imply that God’s Word shows people’s actions to be good or bad. The Bible often speaks of God’s truth as if it were **light** that could reveal the character of something. Alternate translation: [if you compare everything to what God says, you could know if it is good or bad]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:14 (#1)

διὸ

“Therefore”

The connecting word **Therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that their sins will be revealed by the light. The result is that sinners should allow Christ to shine on them. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result. It is unknown if this quotation is a combination of quotations from the prophet Isaiah or a quotation from a hymn sung by the believers.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:14 (#5)

ἐπιφαύσει σοι

“will shine on you”

Here, **you** refers to the "sleeper" and is singular.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Ephesians 5:14 (#3)

ὁ καθεύδων

"O sleeper"

This could mean: (1) Paul is addressing this comment directly to unbelievers who are not reading or hearing the letter. (2) Paul is addressing this comment directly to the believers who are reading or hearing the letter.

See: Apostrophe

Ephesians 5:14 (#6)

ἐπιφαύσει σοι ὁ Χριστός

"Christ will shine on you"

Christ will enable an unbeliever to understand how evil his deeds are and how Christ will forgive him and give him new life, just as light shows what actually is there that the darkness had hidden. This also applies to anything that a believer has not yet recognized as sinful. Alternate translation: [Christ will show you what is right]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:14 (#4)

ἐκ τῶν νεκρῶν

"from the dead"

This expression describes all **dead** people together in the underworld. To arise from among them speaks of becoming alive again and is a metaphor for becoming alive spiritually and living for God. Alternate translation: [from among all those who have died] or [from among those who are spiritually dead]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:14 (#2)

ἔγειρε, ὁ καθεύδων, καὶ ἀνάστα ἐκ τῶν νεκρῶν

"Awake, O sleeper, and arise from the dead"

This could mean: (1) Paul is addressing the believers and using death as a metaphor for the areas of spiritual weakness that they need to become aware of and reject. (2) Paul is addressing unbelievers who need to wake up from being dead spiritually, just as a person who has died must come alive again in order to respond.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:15 (#1)

βλέπετε οὖν ἀκριβῶς πῶς περιπατεῖτε, μὴ ὡς ἄσοφοι, ἀλλ' ὡς σοφοί

"Watch carefully, therefore, how you walk—not as unwise but as wise"

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that people who are **unwise** do not guard themselves against sin. Wise people, however, can identify sin and flee from it. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Therefore, you must be careful to live as a wise person rather than a foolish person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 5:15 (#4)

μὴ ὡς ἄσοφοι, ἀλλ' ὡς σοφοί

"not as unwise but as wise"

The verb "walk" is left out. You can state this clearly. Alternate translation: [not walking as those who are unwise but walking as those who are wise]

See: Ellipsis

Ephesians 5:15 (#5)

μὴ ὡς ἄσοφοι, ἀλλ' ὡς σοφοί

"not as unwise but as wise"

Paul is using the adjectives **unwise** and **wise** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [not as those who act unwisely but as those who act wisely]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Ephesians 5:15 (#3)

ἀλλ'

"but"

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. Being unwise is in contrast to being wise.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:15 (#2)

οὖν

"therefore"

The connecting word **therefore** introduces a reason-result relationship. The reason is that Christ has

shown the light on him. The result is that the sinner will walk carefully in the light. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:16 (#1)

ἐξαγοραζόμενοι τὸν καιρόν

“redeeming the time”

Using time wisely is spoken of as if it were **redeeming the time**. Alternate translation: [doing the best things you can with your time] or [using time wisely] or [putting time to its best use]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:16 (#2)

ὅτι αἱ ἡμέραι πονηραί εἰσιν

“because the days are evil”

The word **days** is a metonym for what people do during those days. Alternate translation: [because the people around you are constantly doing all kinds of evil things and the opportunities that you have to do good may become few]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 5:16 (#3)

ὅτι

“because”

The connecting word **because** introduces the reason of a reason-result relationship. The reason is that the days are evil. The result is that the believers must redeem the time. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:17 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο

“Because of this”

The connecting phrase **Because of this** introduces the result of a reason-result relationship. The reason is that the days are evil. The result is that the believers will not be foolish, but understand God’s will. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:17 (#2)

ἀλλὰ

“but”

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. Being foolish is in contrast to understanding God’s will.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:18 (#1)

καὶ μὴ μεθύσκεσθε οἴνῳ

“And do not get drunk with wine”

Paul ends his instructions on how all believers should live. Alternate translation: [You should not get drunk from drinking wine]

Ephesians 5:18 (#3)

ἀλλὰ πληροῦσθε ἐν Πνεύματι

“Instead, be filled with the Spirit”

Alternate translation: [Instead, you should be controlled by the Holy Spirit]

Ephesians 5:18 (#4)

ἀλλὰ

“Instead”

The connecting word **Instead** introduces a contrast relationship. Being drunk is in contrast to being filled with the Spirit.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:18 (#2)

ἐν ᾧ ἐστιν ἀσωτία

“in which is recklessness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **recklessness**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [which leads to reckless behavior] or [because that will ruin you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 5:19 (#2)

ψαλμοῖς

“psalms”

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that these **psalms** are probably songs from the Old Testament book of Psalms that believers sang in worship.

You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the lyrical poems of David and others]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 5:19 (#1)

ψαλμοῖς, καὶ ὕμνοις, καὶ ᾠδαῖς πνευματικαῖς

"psalms and hymns and spiritual songs"

This could mean: (1) Paul is using these words as a merism for "all sorts of songs to praise God" (2) Paul is listing specific forms of music.

See: Merism

Ephesians 5:19 (#3)

ὕμνοις

"hymns"

These **hymns** are songs of praise and worship that may have been written specifically for Christians to sing.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 5:19 (#4)

ᾠδαῖς πνευματικαῖς

"spiritual songs"

This could mean: (1) these are songs that the Holy Spirit inspires a person to sing right at that moment (2) **spiritual songs** and "hymns" form a doublet. They mean basically the same thing, and you could use one word for these instead of two.

See: Doublet

Ephesians 5:19 (#5)

τῇ καρδίᾳ ὑμῶν

"in your heart"

Here, **heart** is a metonym for a person's thoughts or inner being. This could mean: (1) they should do this with true motives and sincerity. Alternate translation: [from deep within your being] or [sincerely]; (2) they should do this with enthusiasm: Alternate translation: [with all of your being] or [enthusiastically]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 5:20 (#2)

τῷ Θεῷ καὶ Πατρί

"to God, even the Father"

Alternate translation: [to God, who is our Father]

Ephesians 5:20 (#1)

ἐν ὀνόματι τοῦ Κυρίου ἡμῶν, Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ"

Here, **name** could refer to: (1) Jesus himself. Alternate translation: [because you belong to our Lord Jesus Christ]; (2) the authority of Jesus. Alternate translation: [with the authority of our Lord Jesus Christ]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:21–22 (#1)

ὑποτασσόμενοι ἀλλήλοις

"submitting yourselves to one another"

Paul assumes that his readers will understand that he is continuing to explain what it means to "be filled with the Spirit" (Ephesians 5:18). You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Here Paul says that Christians are to submit themselves to one another. Alternate translation: [yielding to fellow believers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 5:21–22 (#2)

αἱ γυναῖκες τοῖς ἰδίοις ἀνδράσιν ὡς τῷ Κυρίῳ

"wives, to your own husbands, as to the Lord"

Paul is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [wives, submitting yourselves to your own husbands, just as you submit yourselves to the Lord]

See: Ellipsis

Ephesians 5:23 (#3)

τοῦ σώματος

"of the body"

The church is often referred to as the **body** of Christ.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:23 (#2)

κεφαλὴ τῆς γυναικὸς & κεφαλὴ τῆς ἐκκλησίας

"the head of the wife & the head of the church"

The word **head** here represents the leader.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:23 (#1)

ὅτι

"For"

The connecting word **For** introduces the reason of the reason-result relationship. The reason is that the husband is head of the wife in the same way that Christ is head of the church. The result is that wives should submit to their husbands. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:25 (#1)

Here the words **himself** and **he** refer to Christ. The word **her** refers to the church.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Ephesians 5:25 (#2)

ἀγαπᾶτε τὰς γυναῖκας

"love your wives"

Here, the command to **love** implies that the husband unselfishly does what is best for the wife, unselfishly serving or giving to his wife, following the example of Christ. Alternate translation: [sacrifice yourselves for your wives]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 5:25 (#4)

ὑπὲρ αὐτῆς

"for her"

Paul speaks of the assembly of believers as though she were a woman whom Jesus will marry. Alternate translation: [for us]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:25 (#3)

ἑαυτὸν παρέδωκεν

"gave himself up"

Alternate translation: [allowed people to kill him]

Ephesians 5:26 (#1)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of Christ giving himself up to death is to sanctify the church.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 5:26 (#3)

καθαρίσας τῷ λουτρῷ τοῦ ὕδατος ἐν ῥήματι

"having cleansed her by the washing of the water with the word"

This could mean: (1) Paul is referring to God making Christ's people clean by the preaching and acceptance of God's **word** in the gospel message and through **water** baptism in Christ. (2) Paul is speaking of God making us spiritually clean from our sins by the message as if God were making our bodies clean by washing them with **water**.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:26 (#2)

αὐτὴν ἁγιάσῃ, καθαρίσας

"he might sanctify her, having cleansed her"

Paul speaks of the assembly of believers as though she were a woman whom Jesus will marry. Alternate translation: [he might make us holy, having cleansed us]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:27 (#3)

μὴ ἔχουσαν σπίλον, ἢ ῥυτίδα

"not having stain or wrinkle"

Here, **stain** and **wrinkle** represent the same idea of defect in two ways to emphasize the church's purity. If your language does not have two different words, you can use one word for this. Alternate translation: [not having damage]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 5:27 (#4)

ἀλλ'

"but"

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. The church having stains and wrinkles of sin is in contrast to the church being holy and blameless.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:27 (#5)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of Christ washing the church is to make the church holy and blameless.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 5:27 (#2)

μὴ ἔχουσαν σπίλον, ἢ ῥυτίδα

“not having stain or wrinkle”

Paul speaks of the church as though it were a garment that is clean and in perfect condition. Alternate translation: [not having any defect]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:27 (#1)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of Christ cleansing the church with the word is to present the church to himself as a glorious bride.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 5:27 (#6)

ἁγία καὶ ἄμωμος

“holy and blameless”

Here, **blameless** means basically the same thing as **holy**. Paul uses the two together to emphasize the church’s purity. If your language does not have two different words, you can use one word for this.

See: Doublet

Ephesians 5:28 (#1)

ὡς τὰ ἑαυτῶν σώματα

“as their own bodies”

You can state explicitly that people love **their own bodies**. Alternate translation: [as husbands love their own bodies]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 5:29 (#2)

ἀλλὰ

“but”

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. Hating one’s own body is in contrast to caring for it.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 5:29 (#1)

ἀλλὰ ἐκτρέφει

“but he nourishes”

Alternate translation: [but he feeds]

Ephesians 5:30 (#2)

μέλη ἐσμὲν τοῦ σώματος αὐτοῦ

“we are members of his body”

Paul speaks of the close union of believers with Christ as if they were part of his own **body**, for which he would naturally care.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 5:30 (#1)

ὅτι

“because”

The connecting word **because** introduces the reason of a reason-result relationship. The reason is that the church is Christ’s body. The result is that Christ cares for the church. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 5:31 (#1)

The quotation is from the writings of Moses in the Old Testament. The word **his** refers to a male believer who marries.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Ephesians 5:31 (#2)

ἀντὶ τούτου

“Because of this”

The connecting phrase **Because of this** introduces the result of a reason-result relationship. In this case, this phrase is part of a quotation from Genesis 2:24, and so the reason is not stated here, but it is stated in Genesis 2:23 that woman was created out of man. The result is that a man will leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife. If it is confusing to not state

the reason, you could include a footnote that says, "the reason for this is that woman was created out of man. See Genesis 2:23"

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians - Chapter 6 Introduction

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Slavery
Paul does not write in this chapter about whether slavery is good or bad. Paul teaches about working to please God whether as a slave or as a master. What Paul teaches here about slavery would have been surprising. In his time, masters were not expected to treat their slaves with respect and not threaten them.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Armor of God
This extended metaphor describes how Christians can protect themselves when spiritually attacked. (See: spirit, wind, breath; and Metaphor)

Ephesians 6:1 (#1)

ἐν Κυρίῳ

"in the Lord"

Paul continues to explain how Christians, people who live **in the Lord**, are to submit themselves to each other. He gives instructions to children, fathers, workers, and masters. Alternate translation: [because you belong to the Lord] or [as followers of the Lord]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:1 (#2)

γάρ

"for"

The connecting word **for** introduces the reason of a reason-result relationship. The reason is that children should do what is right. The result is that children should obey their parents. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 6:1–3 (#1)

The command in verse one is plural. Then in verses two and three Paul quotes from the law of Moses. Moses was talking to the people of Israel as though they were one person, so **your** and **you** are singular there. If that does not make sense, you may need to translate them as plurals.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Ephesians 6:3 (#1)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of obeying your father and mother is to live well and long on the earth.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 6:4 (#3)

ἐκτρέφετε αὐτὰ ἐν παιδείᾳ καὶ νουθεσίᾳ Κυρίου

"raise them in the discipline and instruction of the Lord"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the words **discipline** and **instruction**, you could express the same ideas with verbal forms. Alternate translation: [teach them to become adults by making sure that they know and do what the Lord wants them to do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:4 (#2)

ἀλλὰ

"Instead"

The connecting word **Instead** introduces a contrast relationship. Fathers provoking their children to anger is in contrast to raising their children in discipline and instruction.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 6:4 (#1)

μὴ παροργίζετε τὰ τέκνα ὑμῶν

"do not provoke your children to anger"

Alternate translation: [do not make your children angry] or [do not cause your children to be angry]

Ephesians 6:5 (#5)

ὡς τῷ Χριστῷ

"as to Christ"

To make the meaning of this phrase clear, you may want to include the verb here: "as you obey Christ."

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 6:5 (#1)

φόβου καὶ τρόμου

"fear and trembling"

The phrase **fear and trembling** uses two similar ideas to emphasize the importance of honoring their masters. Alternate translation: [with deep respect]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 6:5 (#4)

ἐν ἁπλότητι

"in honesty"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **honesty**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [honestly] or [sincerely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:5 (#2)

καὶ τρόμου

"and trembling"

Here, **trembling** is an exaggeration used to emphasize how important it is that slaves obey their masters. Alternate translation: [and deep respect] or [as though you were shaking with fear]

See: Hyperbole

Ephesians 6:5 (#3)

ἐν ἁπλότητι τῆς καρδίας ὑμῶν

"in honesty of your heart"

Here, **heart** is a metonym for a person's mind or intentions. Alternate translation: [with honesty] or [with sincerity]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 6:6 (#1)

ἀλλ'

"but"

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. Obeying our masters as men-pleasers is in contrast to obeying them because we are slaves of Christ.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 6:6 (#3)

ἐκ ψυχῆς

"from the soul"

Here, **soul** is a metonym for "attitudes" or "intentions." Alternate translation: [wholeheartedly] or [enthusiastically]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 6:6 (#2)

ὡς δοῦλοι Χριστοῦ

"as slaves of Christ"

Alternate translation: [as though your earthly master were Christ himself]

Ephesians 6:9 (#1)

τὰ αὐτὰ ποιεῖτε πρὸς αὐτούς

"do the same to them"

Here, **the same** refers back to "if he does something good" from (Ephesians 6:8). Alternate translation: [you also must treat your slaves well] or [just as slaves must do good to their masters, you also must do good to your slaves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 6:9 (#3)

προσωπολημψία οὐκ ἔστιν παρ' αὐτῷ

"there is no favoritism with him"

Alternate translation: [he judges everyone the same way]

Ephesians 6:9 (#2)

εἰδότες ὅτι καὶ αὐτῶν καὶ ὑμῶν ὁ Κύριός ἐστιν ἐν οὐρανοῖς

"You know that the Master, both theirs and yours, is in heaven"

Alternate translation: [You know that Christ is the Master of both slaves and their masters, and that he is in heaven]

Ephesians 6:10 (#1)

τοῦ λοιποῦ, ἐνδυναμοῦσθε ἐν Κυρίῳ

"Finally, be strong in the Lord"

Paul is using the word translated **Finally** to introduce a new event in the story. Here Paul gives instructions to make believers strong in this battle we are in for God. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [In conclusion]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Ephesians 6:10 (#2)

τῷ κράτει τῆς ἰσχύος αὐτοῦ

"the force of his strength"

These two words, **force** and **strength**, are very similar in meaning. Together, they reinforce each other. See how you translated this phrase near the end of Ephesians 1:19. Alternate translation: [his great power]

See: Doublet

Ephesians 6:11 (#1)

ἐνδύσασθε τὴν πανοπλίαν τοῦ Θεοῦ, πρὸς τὸ δύνασθαι ὑμᾶς στῆναι πρὸς τὰς μεθοδίας τοῦ διαβόλου

"Put on the whole armor of God, to enable you to stand against the scheming of the devil"

In this metaphor, Paul pictures the spiritual resources that **God** gives to all Christians as a soldier's **armor**. Alternate translation: [Just as a soldier puts on armor to protect himself from enemy attacks, use all of God's resources to stand firmly against the devil]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:11 (#2)

τὰς μεθοδίας

"the scheming"

Alternate translation: [the tricky plans]

Ephesians 6:12 (#4)

πρὸς τοὺς κοσμοκράτορας

"against the world-controllers"

Here it is implied that **the world-controllers** refers to powerful spiritual beings. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [against the powerful spiritual beings that rule over people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 6:12 (#1)

ὅτι

"For"

The connecting word **For** introduces the reason of this reason-result relationship. The reason is that we are in a struggle against spiritual forces of darkness. The result is that we should put on the whole armor of God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 6:12 (#5)

τοῦ σκότους τούτου

"of this darkness"

Here, **darkness** is a metaphor for things that are evil. Alternate translation: [during this present evil time]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:12 (#3)

ἀλλὰ

"but"

The connecting word **but** introduces a contrast relationship. People made of flesh and blood are in contrast to spiritual forces.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Ephesians 6:12 (#2)

αἷμα καὶ σάρκα

"blood and flesh"

This expression refers to people, not to spirits who do not have human bodies. Alternate translation: [human beings]

See: Synecdoche

Ephesians 6:13 (#2)

διὰ τοῦτο

"Because of this"

The connecting phrase **Because of this** introduces the result of a reason-result relationship. The reason is that we are in a battle against evil spiritual forces. The result is that we should put on the whole armor of God. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 6:13 (#1)

διὰ τοῦτο, ἀναλάβετε τὴν πανοπλίαν τοῦ Θεοῦ

"Because of this, put on the whole armor of God"

Christians should use the protective resources **God** gives them in fighting the devil in the same way that a soldier puts on **armor** to protect himself against his enemies.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:13 (#5)

ἵνα

“so that”

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of putting on the whole armor of God is to be able to withstand the attacks of the spiritual forces of darkness.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 6:13 (#3)

ἵνα δυνηθῆτε ἀντιστῆναι ἐν τῇ ἡμέρᾳ τῇ πονηρᾷ

“so that you may be able to withstand in the evil day”

The word **withstand** means to successfully resist something. Alternate translation: [so that you may be able to resist when evil attacks you]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:13 (#4)

ἵνα δυνηθῆτε ἀντιστῆναι

“so that you may be able to withstand”

It may be helpful to state explicitly what believers are to **withstand**. Alternate translation: [so that you may be able to withstand the attacks of the devil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 6:14 (#3)

περιζωσάμενοι τὴν ὀσφὺν ὑμῶν ἐν ἀληθείᾳ

“having girded up your loins with truth”

In this metaphor, **truth** is compared to a soldier’s belt. Truth holds everything together for a believer just as a belt holds the clothing of a soldier together. Alternate translation: [having wrapped yourself in all that is true]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:14 (#2)

οὖν

“therefore”

The connecting word **therefore** introduces the result of a reason-result relationship. The reason is that we believers have put on our spiritual armor. The result is that we will stand and resist the evil spiritual forces. Use a phrase in your language that connects a reason to a result.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Ephesians 6:14 (#6)

τῆς δικαιοσύνης

“of righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **righteousness**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [the right way to live]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:14 (#5)

ἐνδυσάμενοι τὸν θώρακα τῆς δικαιοσύνης

“having put on the breastplate of righteousness”

In this metaphor, **righteousness** is compared to a soldier’s **breastplate**. Just as soldiers put on a breastplate to protect themselves from enemy attacks, believers should behave in a righteous way to protect themselves from spiritual attacks.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:14 (#1)

στῆτε οὖν

“Stand, therefore”

The word **Stand** represents taking a position on what is right and true and successfully resisting forces that try to make the believer compromise that position. See how you translated “stand firm” in Ephesians 6:13. Alternate translation: [So resist evil]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:14 (#4)

ἀληθείᾳ

“truth”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **truth**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [what is true]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:15 (#2)

τῆς εἰρήνης

“of peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **peace**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [that makes everything good between people and God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:15 (#1)

ὑποδησάμενοι τοὺς πόδας ἐν ἑτοιμασίᾳ τοῦ εὐαγγελίου τῆς εἰρήνης

"having shod your feet with readiness of the gospel of peace"

In this metaphor, **the gospel of peace** is compared to a soldier's sandals. Just as a soldier wears sturdy footwear to give him solid footing and enable him to march long distances, the believer must have solid knowledge of the gospel of peace and be ready to go where the Lord sends him to proclaim it.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:16 (#3)

τὰ βέλη τοῦ πονηροῦ πεπυρωμένα

"the flaming arrows of the evil one"

The attacks of the devil against a believer are like **flaming arrows** shot at a soldier by an enemy.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:16 (#2)

τῆς πίστεως

"of the faith"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **faith**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [that represents how much you trust in the Lord]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:16 (#1)

ἐν πᾶσιν ἀναλαβόντες τὸν θυρεὸν τῆς πίστεως

"In everything take up the shield of the faith"

In this metaphor, faith is compared to a soldier's **shield**. Just as a soldier uses a shield to protect himself from enemy attacks, the believer must use the **faith** that God gives for protection when the devil attacks.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:17 (#3)

τὴν μάχαιραν τοῦ Πνεύματος, ὅ ἐστιν ῥῆμα Θεοῦ

"the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God"

In this metaphor, God's message is compared to a soldier's **sword**. Just as soldiers use a sword to fight and defeat their enemy, so a believer can use God's message in the Bible to fight against the devil.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:17 (#2)

τοῦ σωτηρίου

"of salvation"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **salvation**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [that represents the fact that God has saved you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:17 (#1)

τὴν περικεφαλαίαν τοῦ σωτηρίου δέξασθε

"take the helmet of salvation"

The **salvation** that God gives protects the believer's mind just as a **helmet** protects the head of a soldier.

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:18 (#3)

ἀγρυπνοῦντες ἐν πάσῃ προσκαρτερήσει καὶ δεήσει περὶ πάντων τῶν ἁγίων

"be watchful with all perseverance and requests for all the saints"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **perseverance**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [persevere in being alert, and pray for all God's holy people] or [pray with constant alertness for all the believers]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:18 (#2)

εἰς αὐτὸ

"to this {end"

The connecting phrase **to this {end}** marks a goal or purpose relationship. The goal is what was just mentioned: to pray at all times in the Spirit. In order to do that, believers must be watchful and persevere in

making requests for all the saints. Alternate translation: [for this reason] or [in order to do that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 6:18 (#1)

διὰ πάσης προσευχῆς καὶ δεήσεως, προσευχόμενοι ἐν παντὶ καιρῷ ἐν Πνεύματι

"With every prayer and request, pray at all times in the Spirit"

Alternate translation: [Pray at all times in the Spirit as you pray and make specific requests]

Ephesians 6:19 (#1)

καὶ ὑπὲρ ἐμοῦ

"and for me"

Paul is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. In closing this letter, Paul asks his readers to pray for his boldness in telling the gospel. Alternate translation: [and pray for me]

See: Ellipsis

Ephesians 6:19 (#4)

ἀνοίξει τοῦ στόματός μου

"the opening of my mouth"

This is a metonym for speaking. Alternate translation: [my speaking] or [in what I say]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 6:19 (#3)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of the believers praying for Paul is to enable him to preach the gospel boldly.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 6:19 (#2)

ἵνα μοι δοθῇ λόγος

"so that a message might be given to me"

If your language does not use this passive form, you can state this in active form. Alternate translation: [that God might give me the word] or [God might give me the message]

See: Active or Passive

Ephesians 6:20 (#4)

ἐν αὐτῷ

"in it"

Here, **it** refers back to the "message" in verse 19 that Paul wants to speak. If it would be helpful in your language, you could repeat the word "message" here. Alternate translation: [in my message]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Ephesians 6:20 (#3)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of the believers praying for Paul is to enable him to preach the gospel boldly even though he is in chains.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 6:20 (#2)

ἵνα ἐν αὐτῷ παρρησιάσωμαι, ὡς δεῖ με λαλῆσαι

"so that in it I may speak boldly, as it is necessary for me to speak"

The word "pray" is understood from verse 18. Alternate translation: [pray that whenever I teach the gospel, I will speak it as boldly as I should] or [pray that I may speak the gospel as boldly as I should]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Ephesians 6:20 (#1)

ὑπὲρ οὗ πρεσβεύω ἐν ἁλύσει

"for which I am an ambassador in chains"

The phrase **in chains** is a metonym for being in prison. Alternate translation: [because of which I am now in prison]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 6:21 (#1)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of Paul sending Tychicus

to Ephesus was to tell the Ephesian believers what was happening to Paul.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 6:21 (#2)

ἀδελφὸς

"brother"

Paul speaks of Tychicus as if he were a **brother** to all the other believers who were in God's spiritual family. Alternate translation: [fellow believer]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:22 (#2)

ἵνα

"so that"

The connecting phrase **so that** introduces a goal relationship. The goal or purpose of Paul sending Tychicus to the Ephesians is to encourage their hearts and to let them know what was happening to Paul and his companions.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Ephesians 6:22 (#1)

παρακαλέσῃ τὰς καρδίας ὑμῶν

"your hearts may be encouraged"

Here, **hearts** is a metonym for people's inner beings. Alternate translation: [he may encourage you]

See: Metonymy

Ephesians 6:23 (#1)

εἰρήνη τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς καὶ ἀγάπη μετὰ πίστεως ἀπὸ Θεοῦ Πατρὸς καὶ Κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

"Peace to the brothers, and love with faith from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ"

Paul closes his letter to the Ephesian believers with a blessing of **Peace** and **love** on all believers who love Christ. You could express this as either a blessing or a prayer, in whichever way is more natural in your language.

See: Blessings

Ephesians 6:23 (#3)

τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

"to the brothers"

Paul speaks of the other believers as if they were **brothers** to all of the other believers who were in God's spiritual family. Alternate translation: [to the fellow believers]

See: Metaphor

Ephesians 6:23 (#4)

ἀγάπη

"love"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **love**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [may you love one another]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:23 (#5)

μετὰ πίστεως

"with faith"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **faith**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [as you trust in the Lord]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:23 (#2)

εἰρήνη τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς

"Peace to the brothers"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **Peace**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [May the brothers have a peaceful spirit]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:24 (#2)

ἐν ἀφθαρσίᾳ

"with incorruptibility"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **incorruptibility**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [in a way that no one is able to corrupt] or [so much that no one can make them stop loving him]

See: Abstract Nouns

Ephesians 6:24 (#1)

ἡ χάρις μετὰ

Ephesians 6:24 (#1)

“Grace {be} with”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **Grace**, you could express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [May God act graciously to]

See: Abstract Nouns